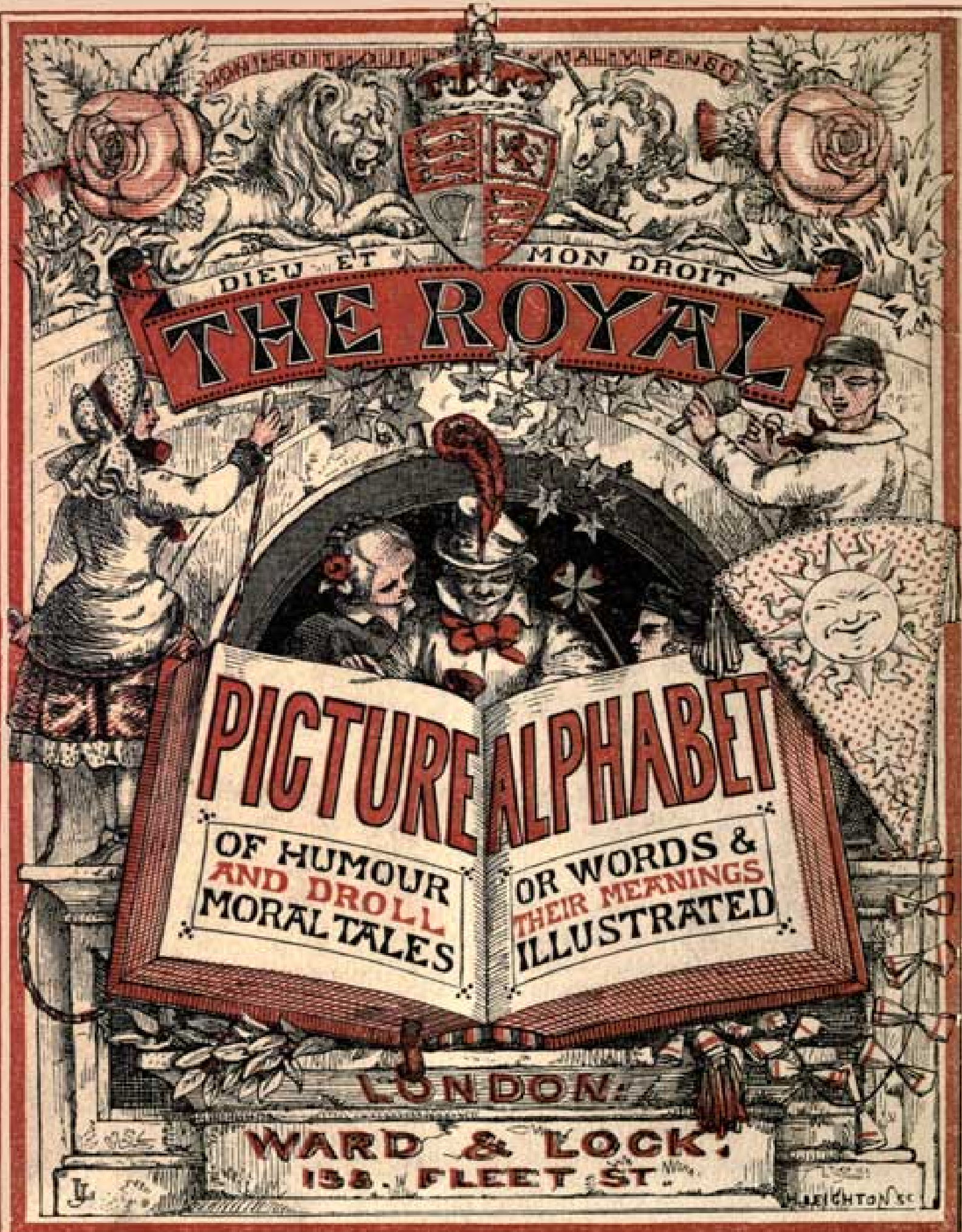




DIEU ET MON DROIT

# THE ROYAL

## PICTURE ALPHABET

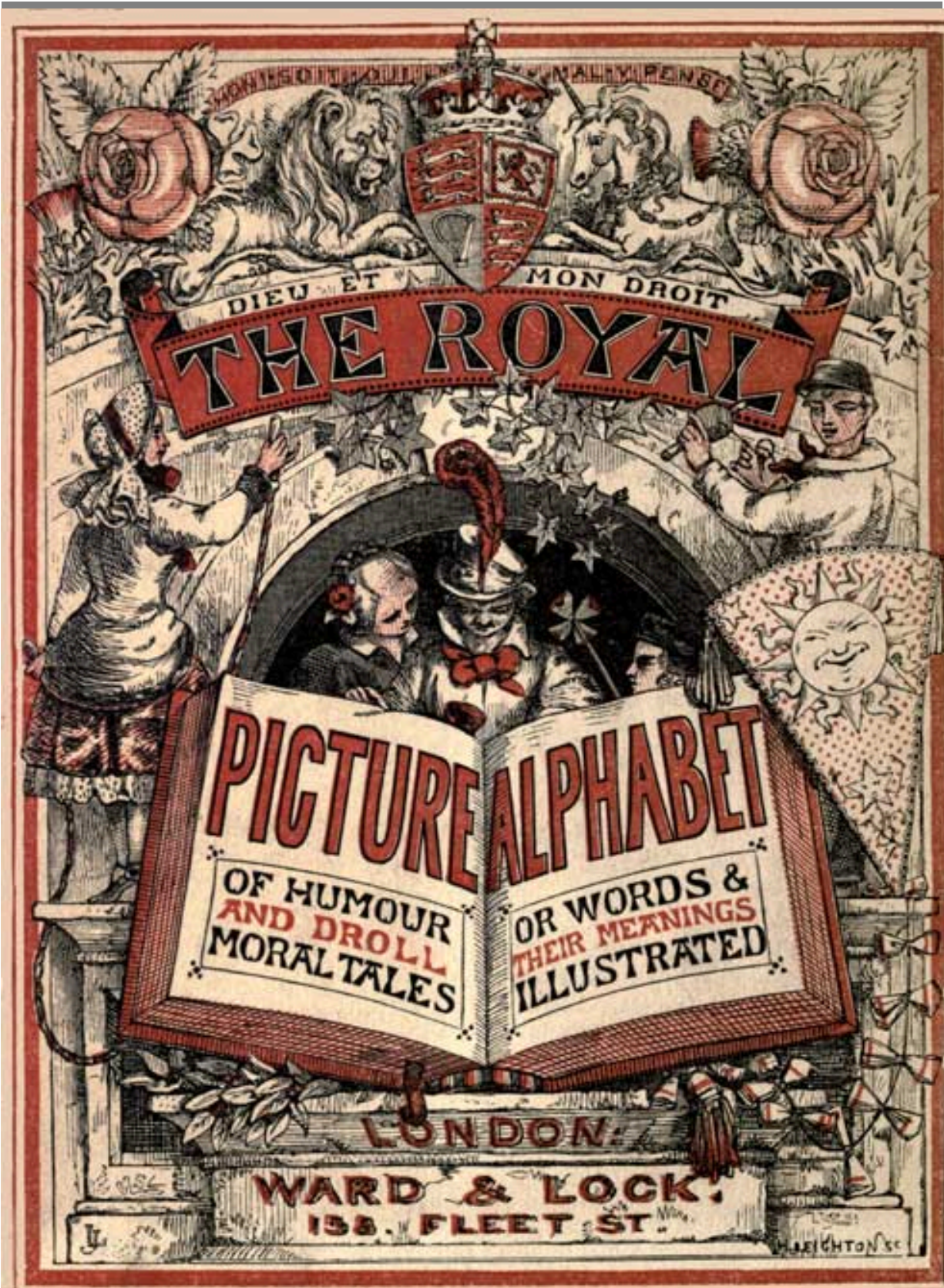
OF HUMOUR  
AND DROLL  
MORAL TALES

OR WORDS &  
THEIR MEANINGS  
ILLUSTRATED

LONDON  
**WARD & LOCK,**  
138, FLEET ST.

PRICE ONE SHILLING.





PRICE ONE SHILLING.

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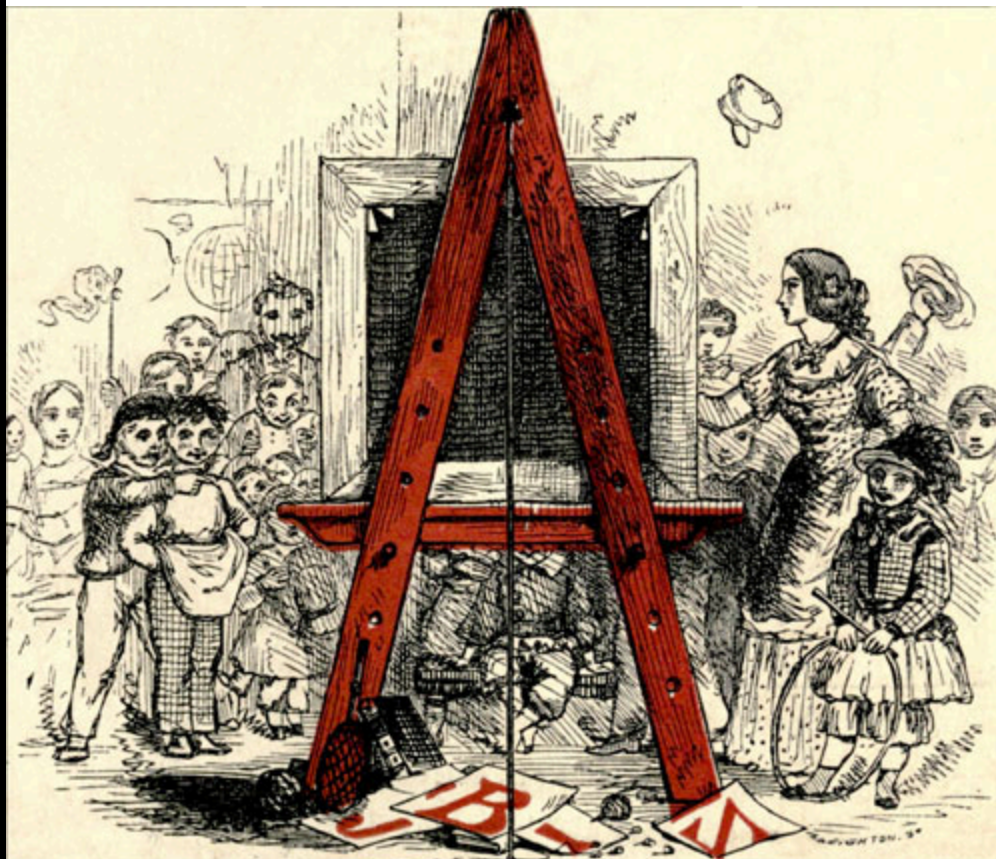
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PICTURE ALPHABET \*\*\***





# THE ROYAL PICTURE ALPHABET.



LONDON:  
**WARD AND LOCK,**  
158, FLEET STREET.

**POETICAL PREFACE**  
**TO THE**  
**ROYAL PICTURE ALPHABET.**

---

**TO PRECEPTORS.**

With learning may laughter be found,  
    “’Tis good to be merry and wise;”  
To gaily get over the ground,  
    As higher and higher we rise.

Some children their letters may learn,  
    While others will surely do more,  
As the subjects suggestively turn

To matters not thought of before.

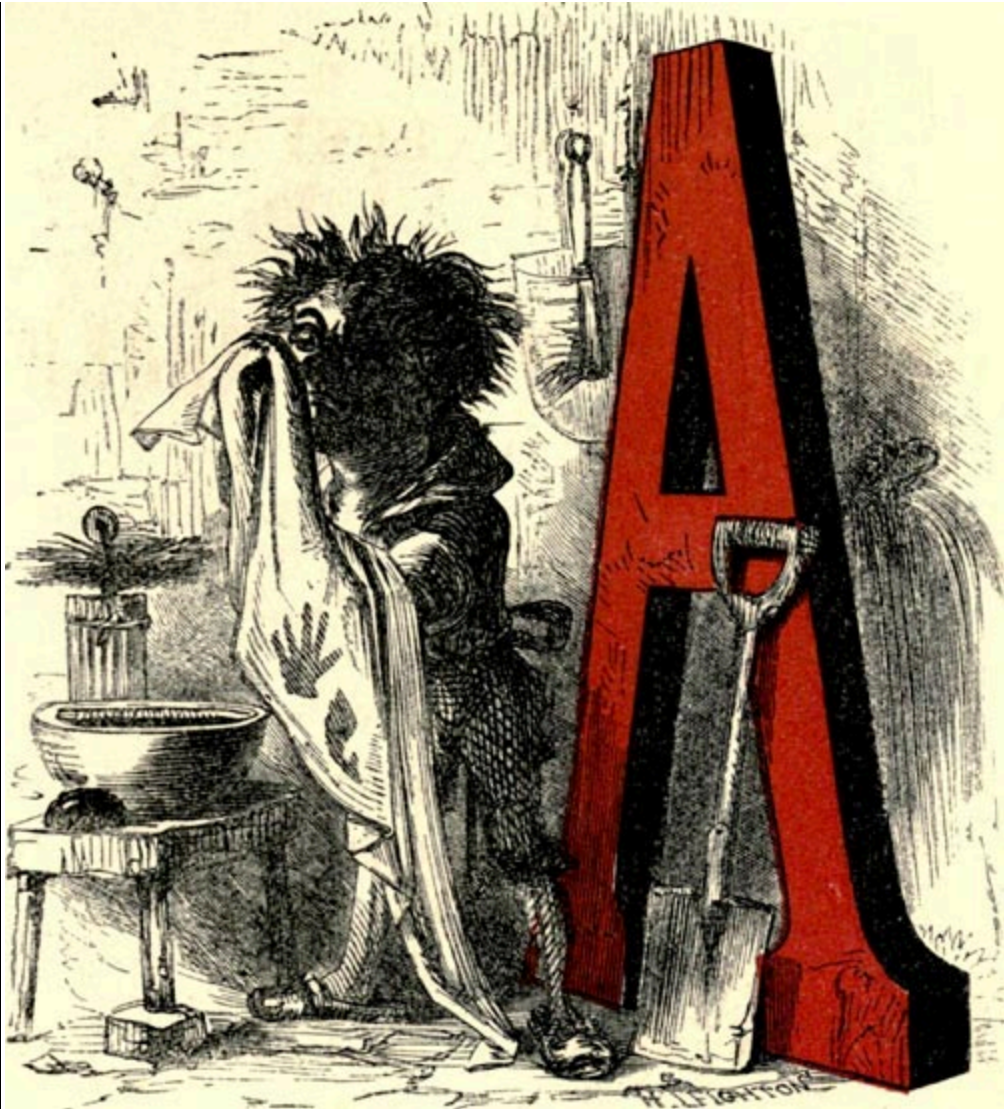
Descriptions and pictures combined

Are here made attractive and clear;

So suited that children may find

From error the truth to appear.





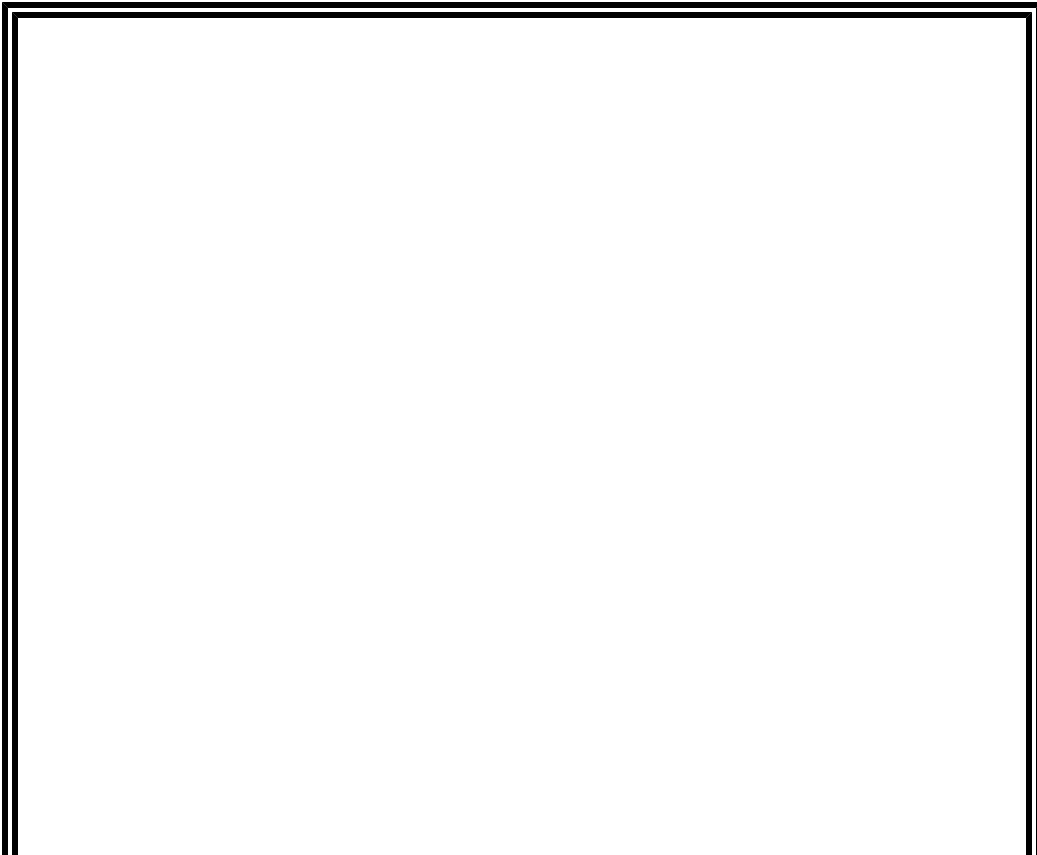
Aa.

ABLUTION,  
*The Act of Cleansing.*

The little sweep has washed his  
face,



But not as we advise:  
For black as soot he's made the  
    soap,  
And rubbed it in his eyes.





Bb.

BARTER,  
*Exchange.*

Here's Master Mack presenting  
fruit,  
Of which he makes display;  
He knows he'll soon have Lucy's  
rope,  
And with it skip away.



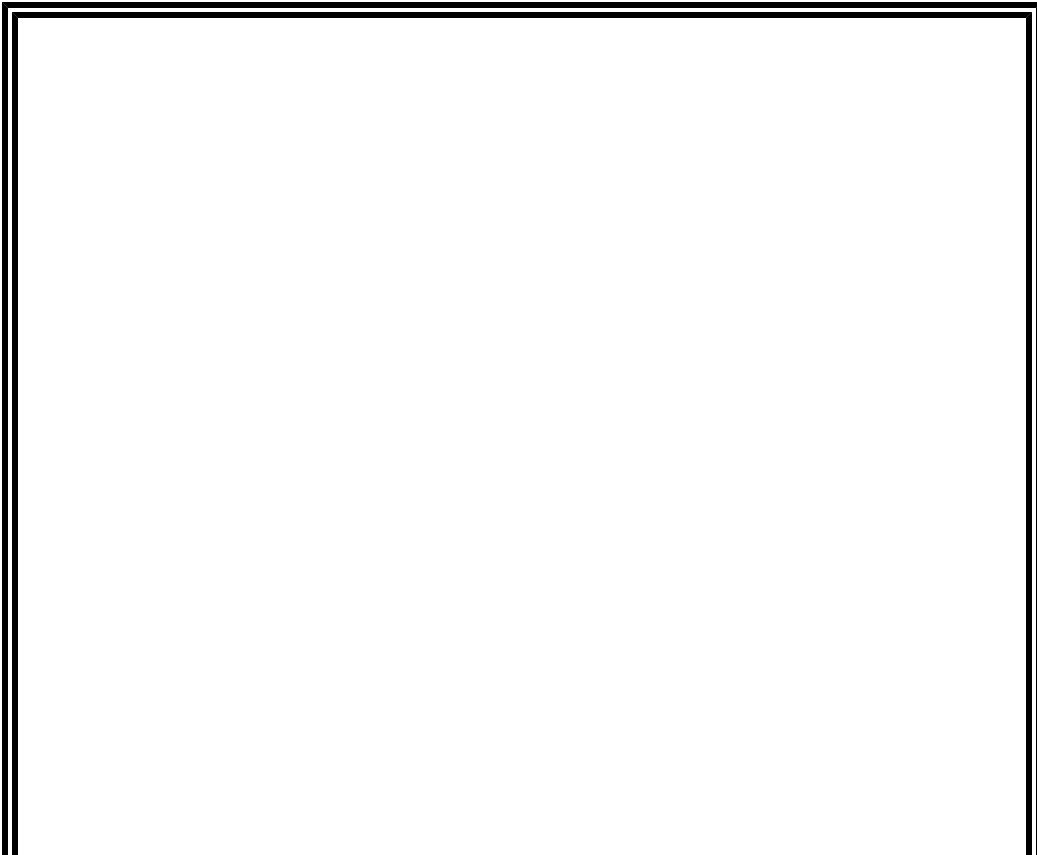


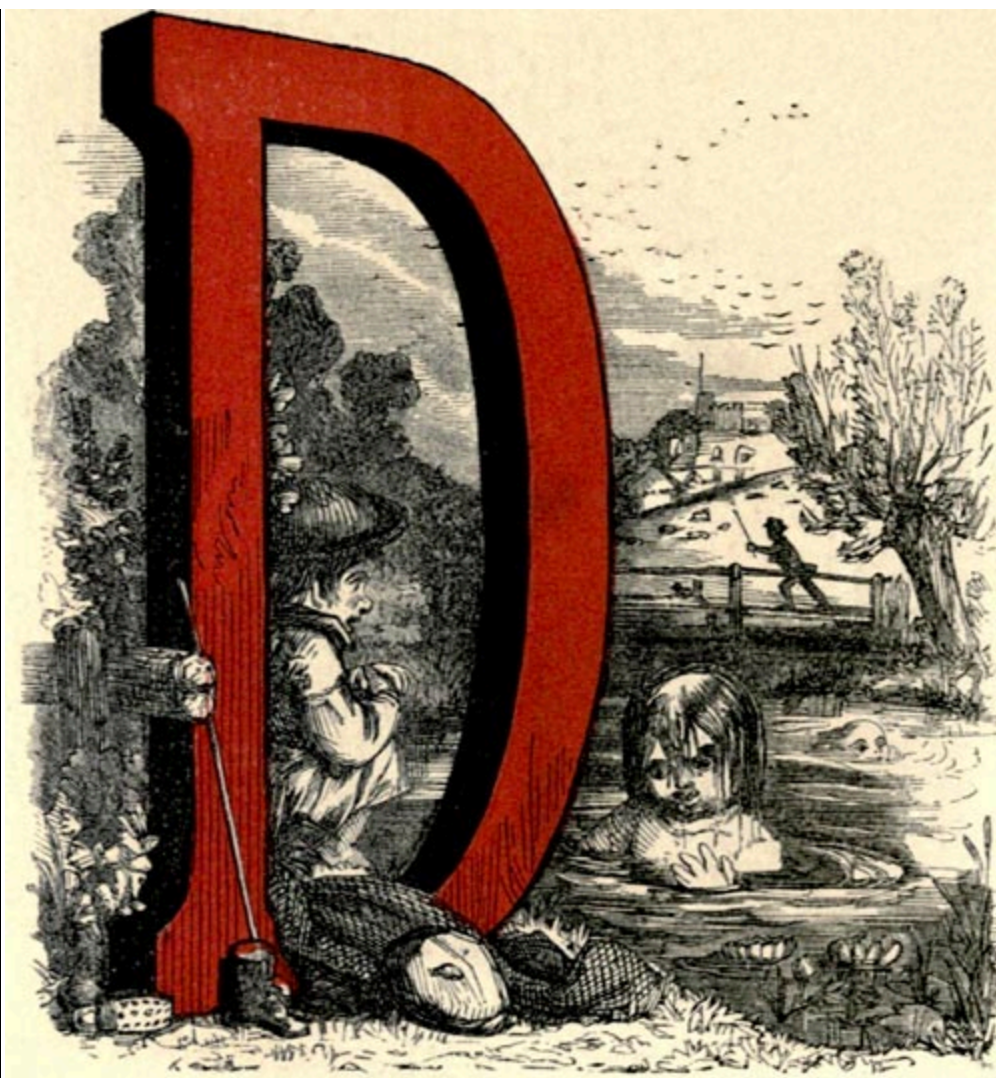
Cc.

CATASTROPHE, *a Final  
Event  
(generally unhappy).*

“Oh here’s a sad catastrophe!”

Was Mrs. Blossom's cry—  
Then—"Water! water! bring to me  
—  
Or all my fish will die."





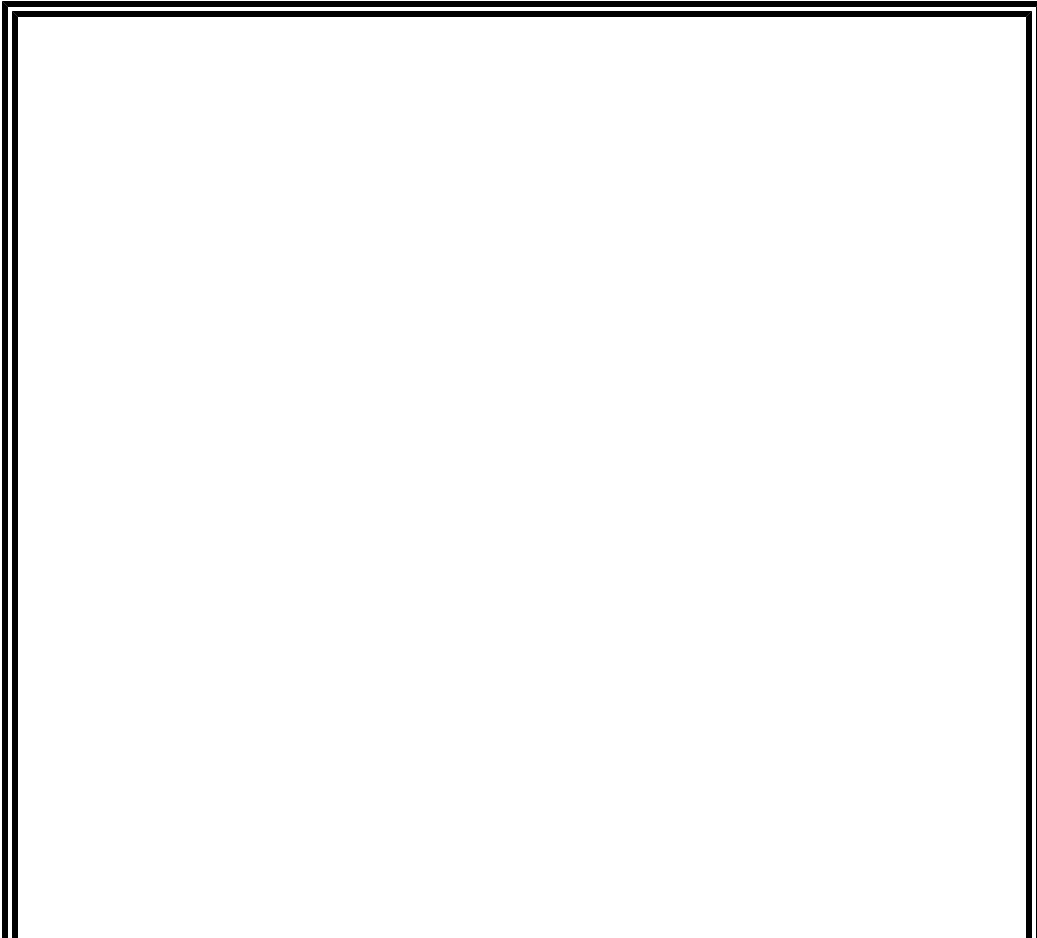
Dd.

DELIGHTFUL,  
*Pleasant, Charming.*

These boys are bathing in the  
stream



When they should be at school:  
The master's coming round to see  
Who disregards his rule.



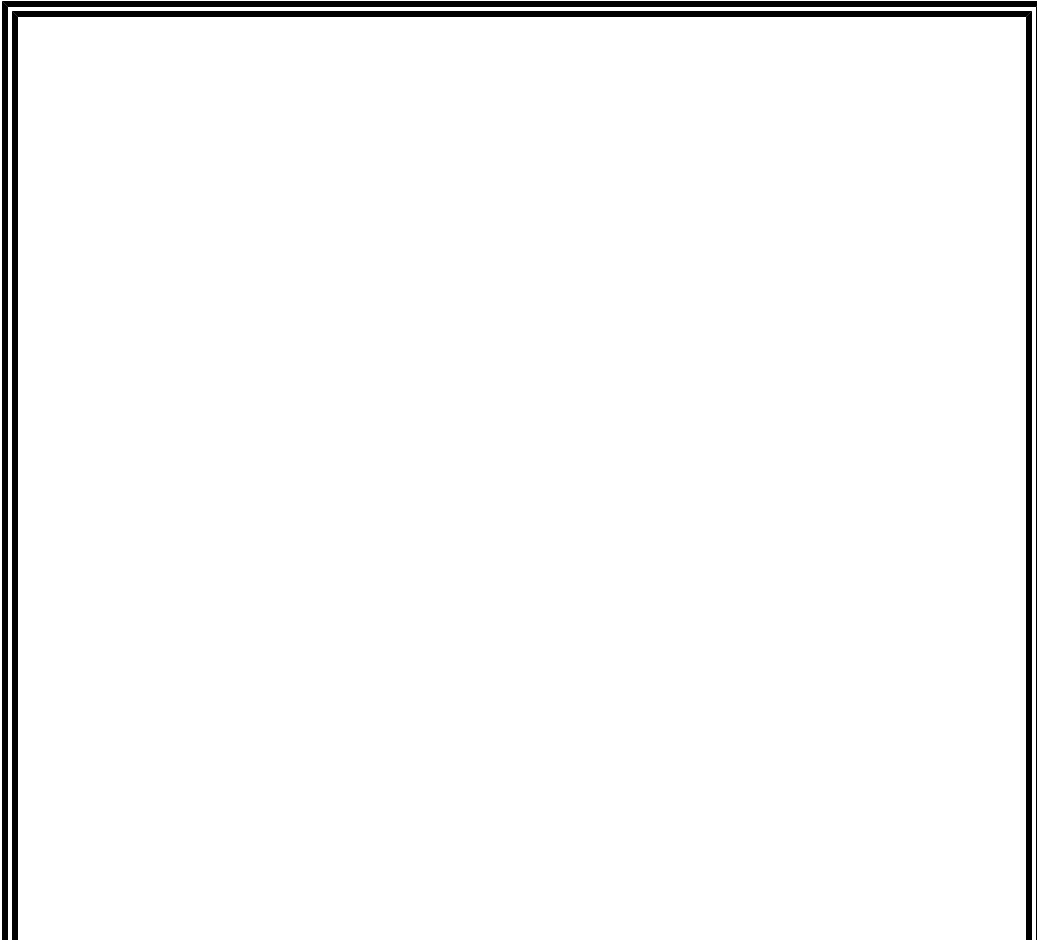


Ee.

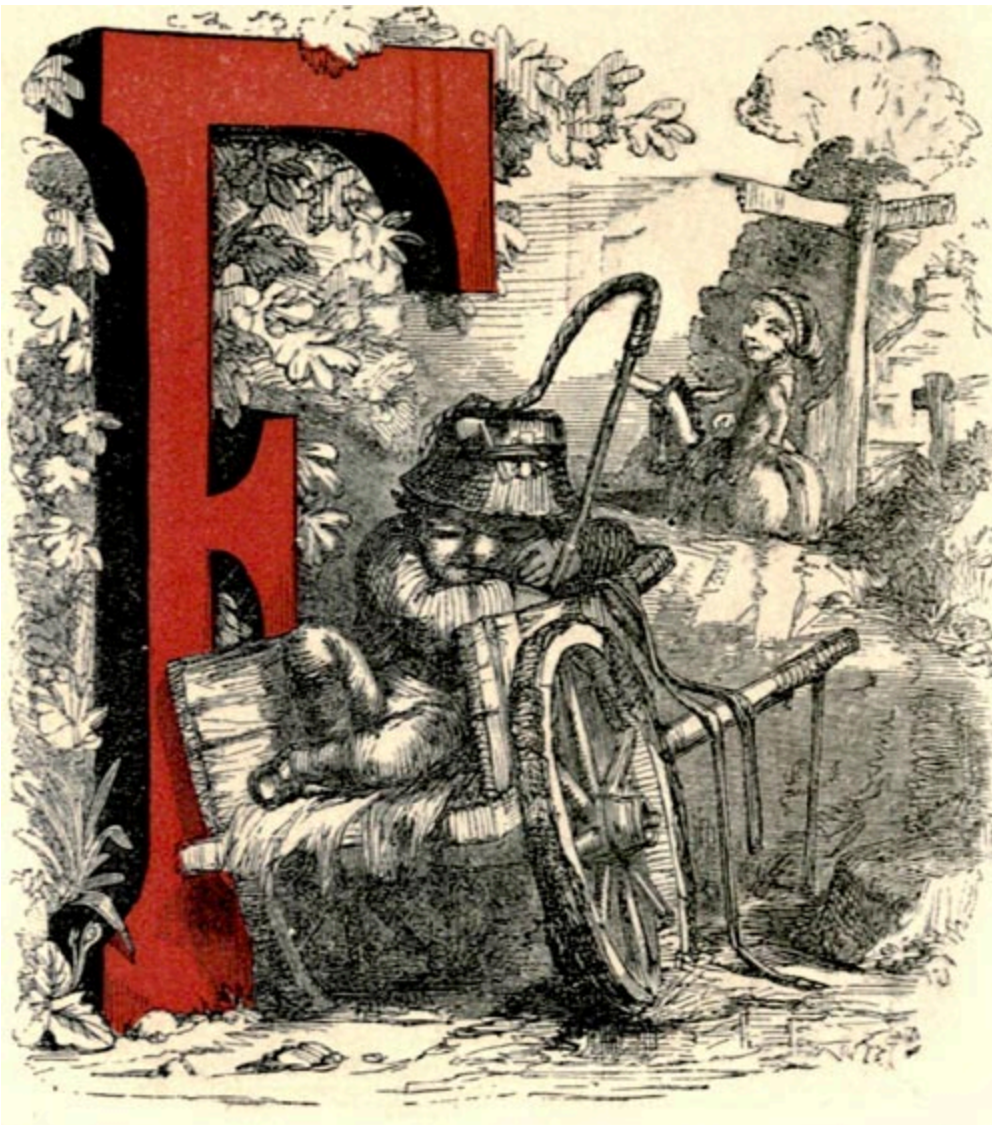
ECCENTRICITY,  
*Irregularity, Strangeness.*

We often see things seeming  
strange;

But scarce so strange as this:—  
Here everything is mis-applied,  
Here every change amiss.







**Ff.**

FRAUD,  
*Deceit, Trick, Artifice,*  
*Cheat.*

Here is Pat Murphy, fast asleep.

And there is Neddy Bray:  
The thief a watchful eye doth keep  
Until he gets away.

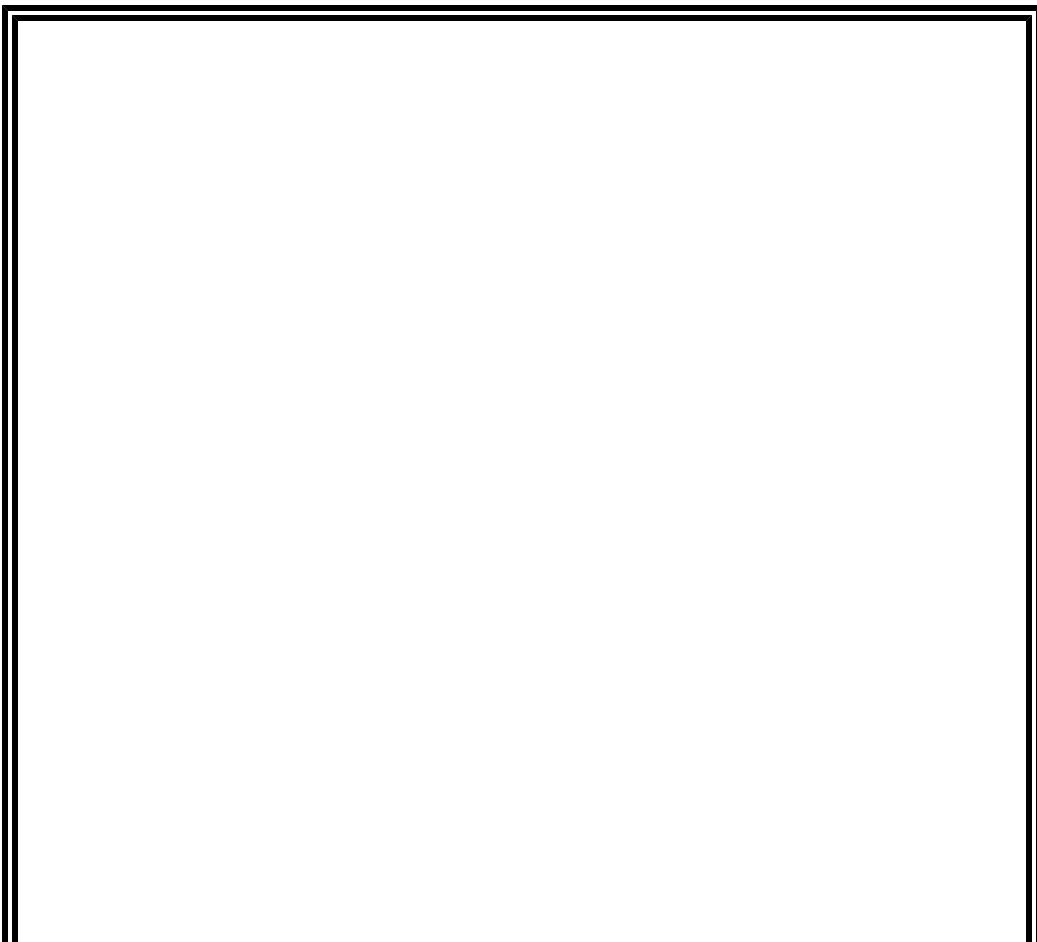


Gg.

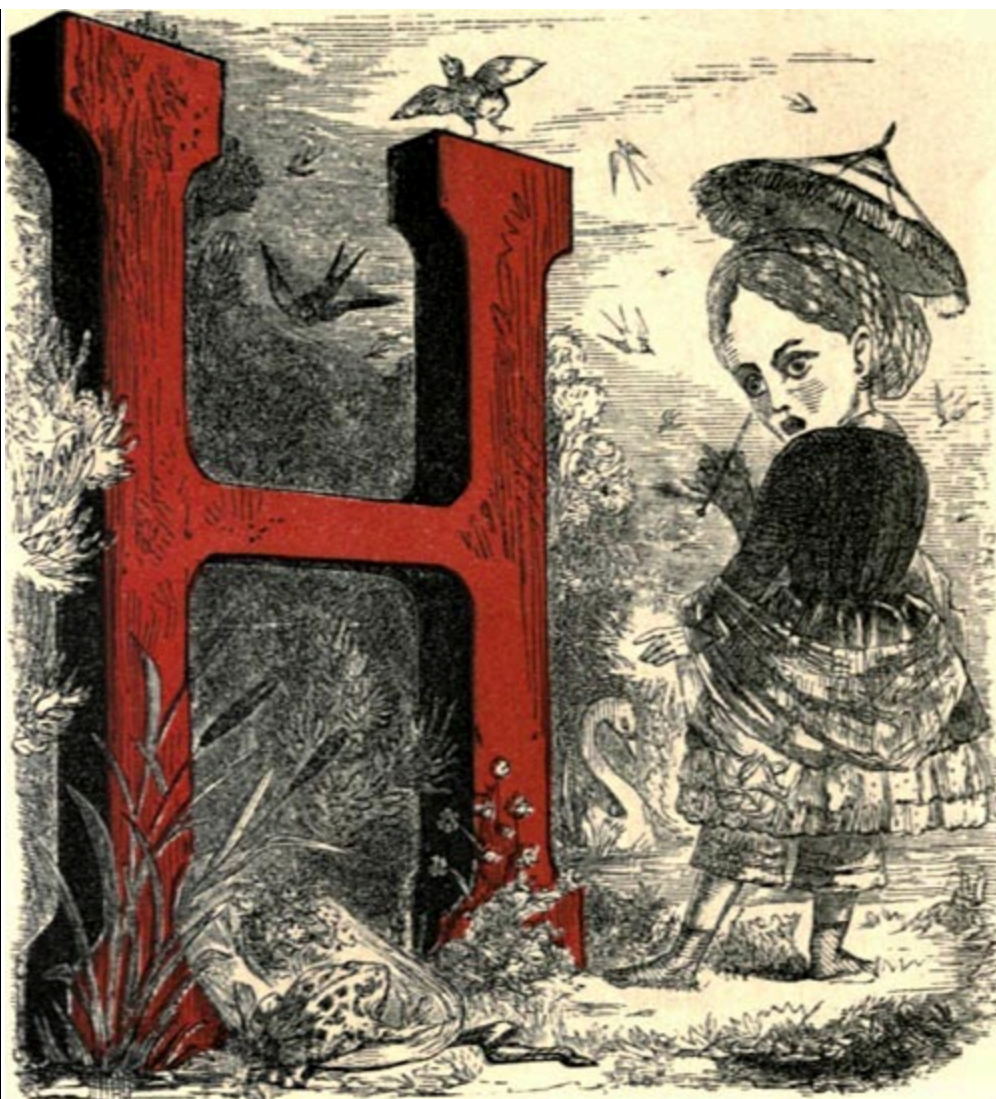
GENIUS,  
*Mental Power, Faculty.*

A little boy with little slate  
May sometimes make more clear

The little thoughts that he would  
state  
Than can by words appear.





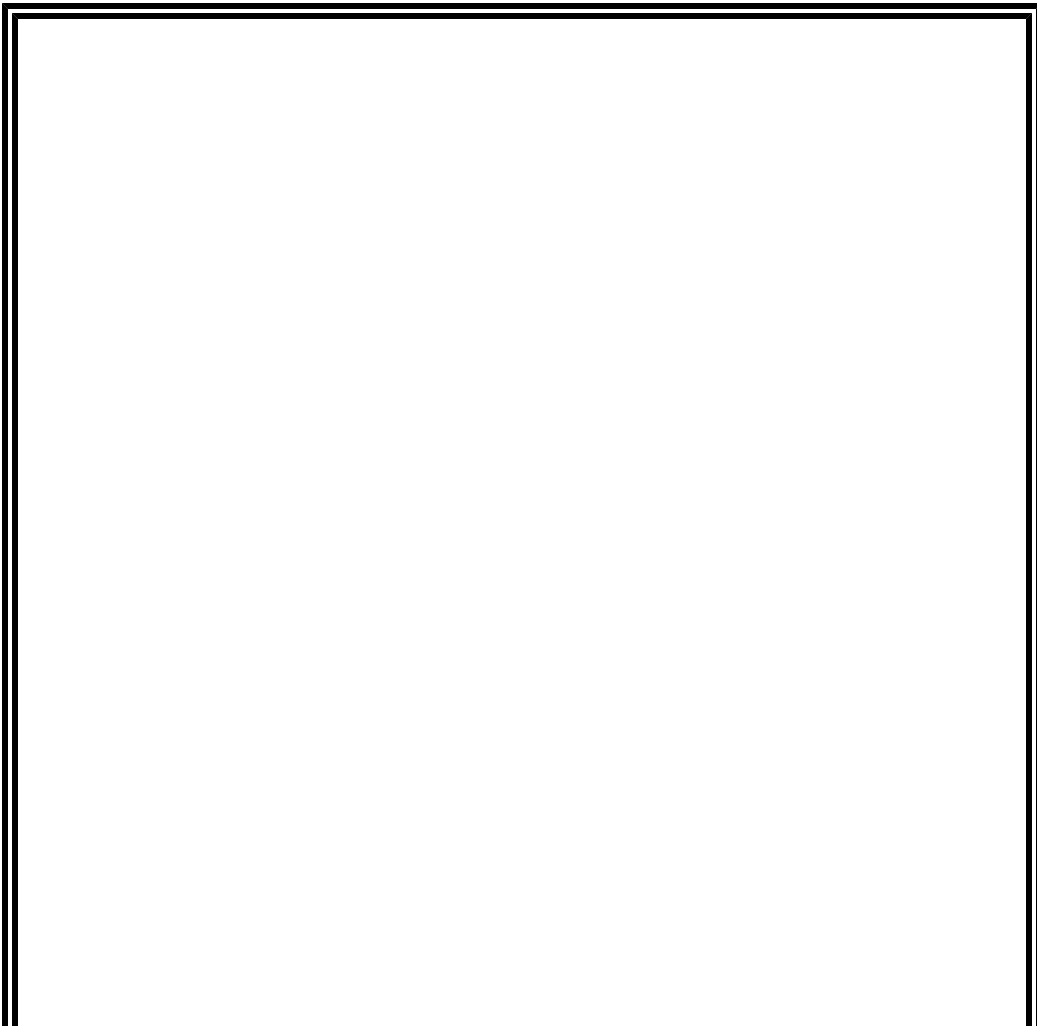


Hh.

HORROR,  
*Terror, Dread.*

This little harmless speckled frog  
Seems Lady Townsend's dread:

I fear she'll run away and cry,  
And hide her silly head.





Ii. Jj.

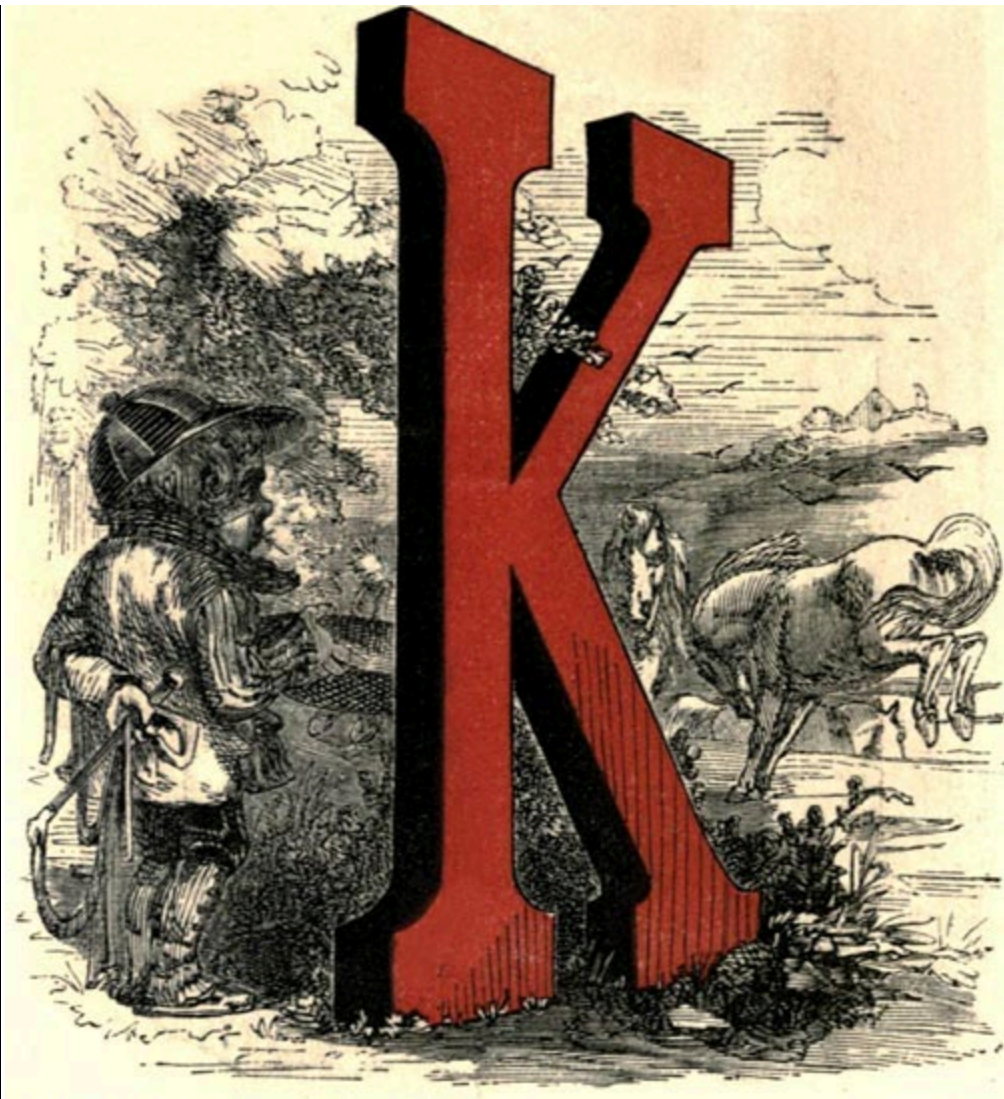
ICHABOD AT THE  
JAM.

ICHABOD, *a Christian  
Name.*

*JAM, a Conserve of  
Fruits.*

Enough is good, excess is bad:  
Yet Ichabod you see,  
Will with the jam his stomach cram,  
Until they disagree.



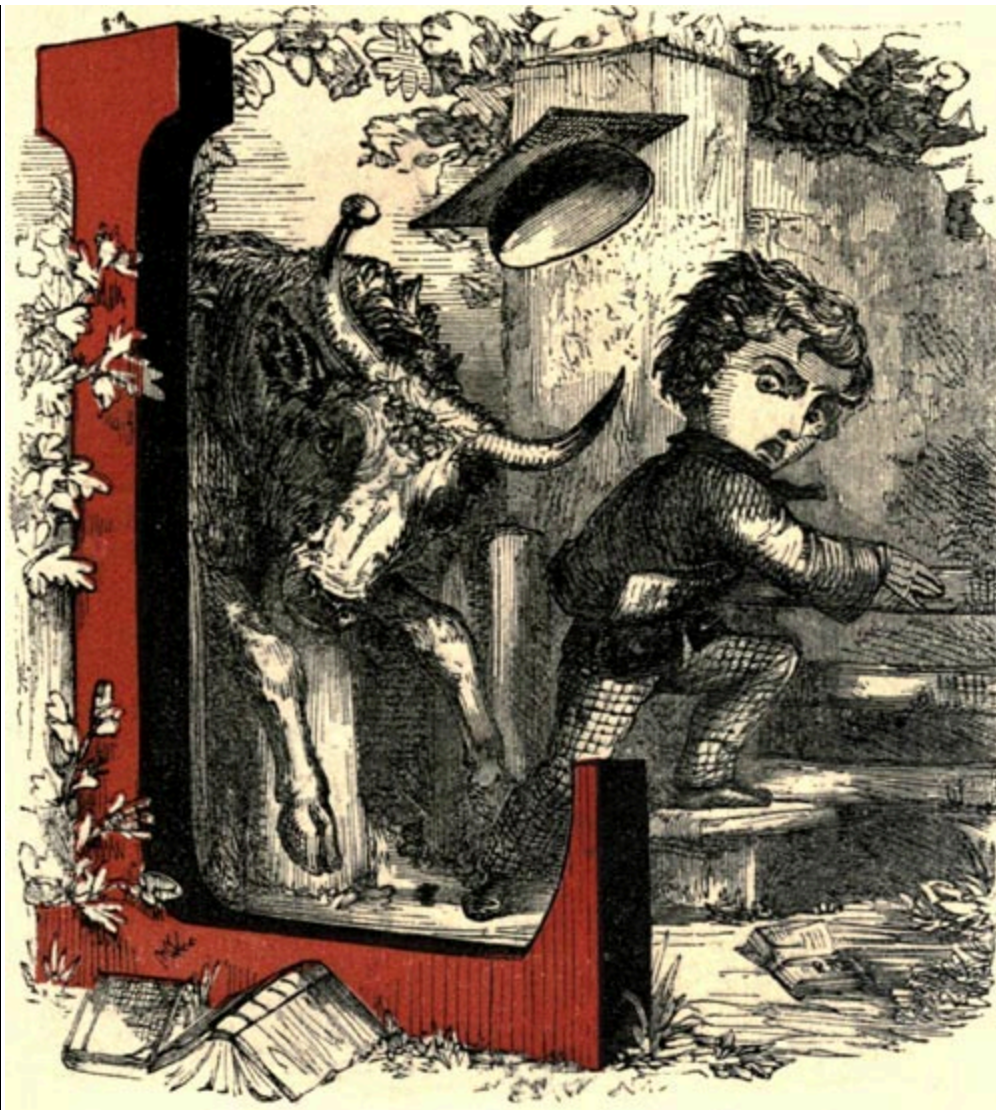


Kk.

KNOWING,  
*Conscious, Intelligent.*

Tho' horses know both beans and  
corn,

And snuff them in the wind;  
They also all know Jemmy Small,  
And what he holds behind.



Ll.

LUCKY,  
*Fortunate, Happy by  
Chance.*

We must admire, in Lovebook's  
case.

The prompt decision made:  
As he could not have gained the  
wood  
If time had been delayed.





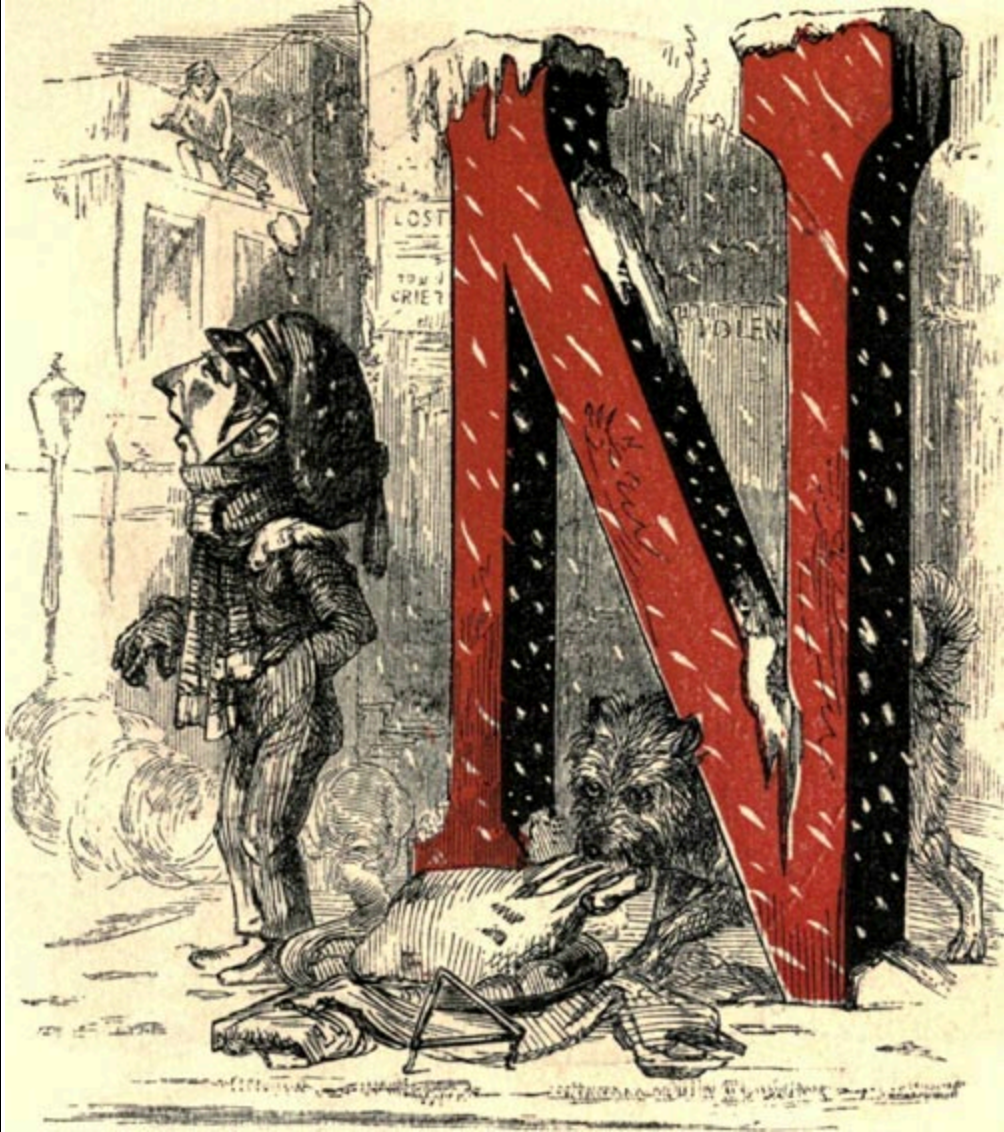
Mm.

MIMIC,  
*Imitative, Burlesque.*

The Gentleman, who struts so fine,  
Unconscious seems to be

Of Imitation by the boy

Who has the street-door key.



Nn.

NEGLIGENCE,  
*Heedlessness,*  
*Carelessness.*

The character Tom Slowboy bears  
Would much against him tell—  
For any work that's wanted done,  
Or even play done well.



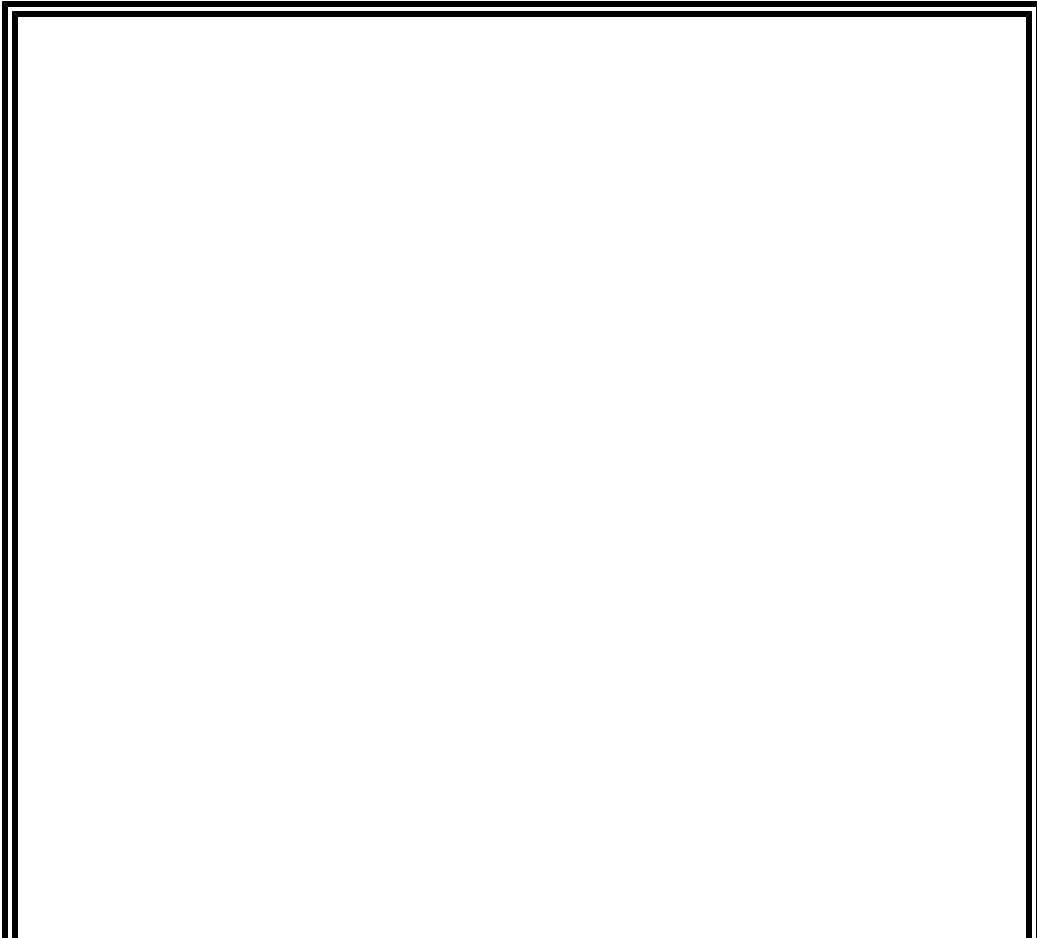


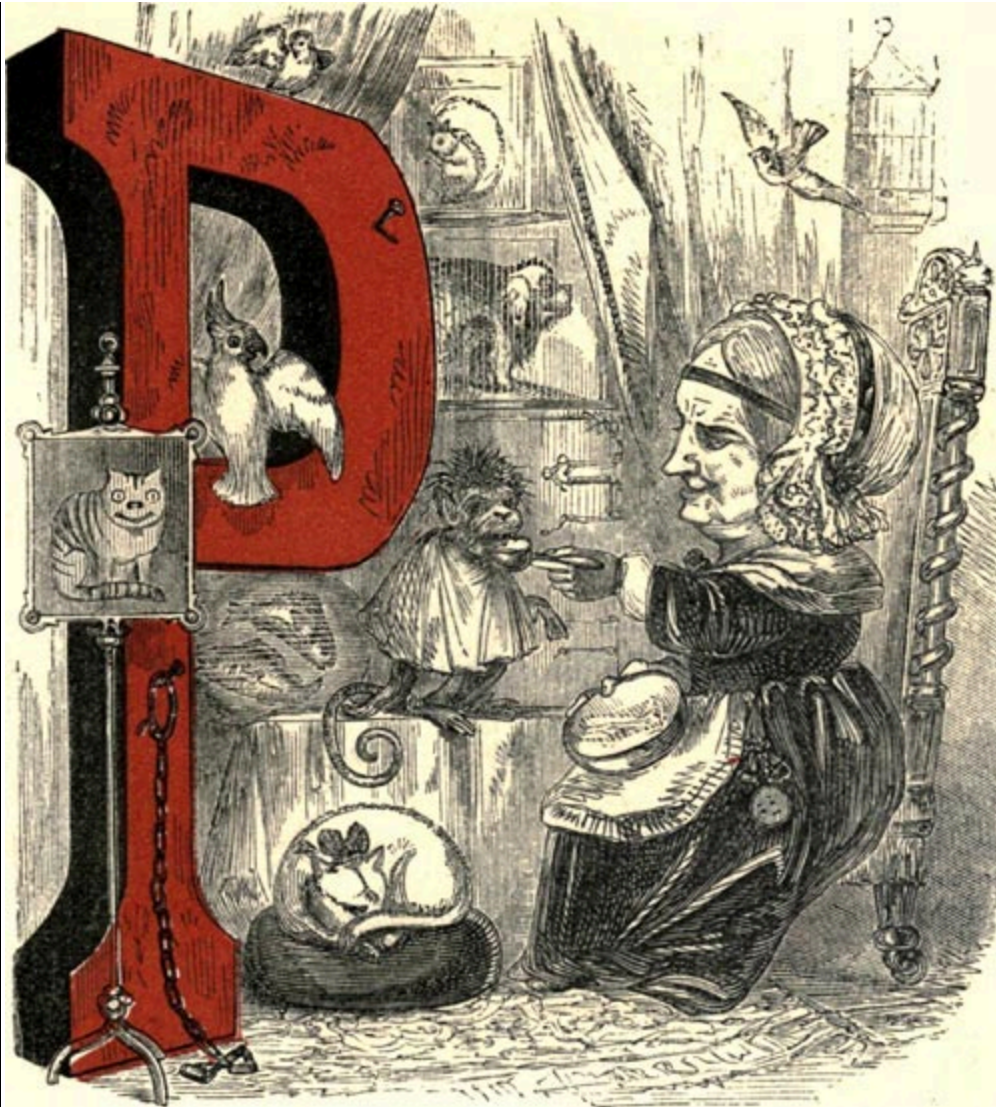
Oo.

OBSTINACY,  
*Stubbornness,*  
*Waywardness.*

The obstinacy of the pig

Is nature—as you see:  
But boys and girls who have a mind  
Should never stubborn be.



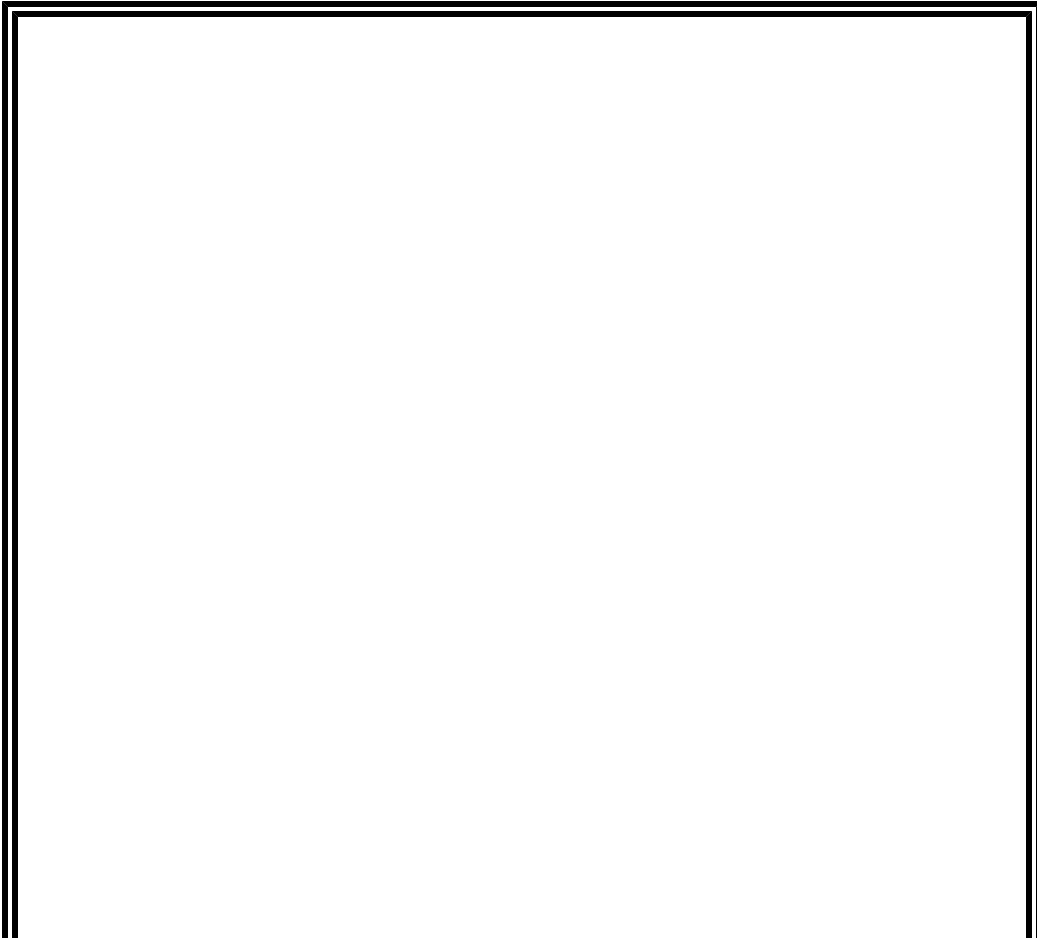


Pp.

PETS,  
*Favourites, Spoilt  
Fondlings.*

Some people say that Auntie Gray

To animals is kind;  
We think, instead, they are over fed,  
And kept too much confined.





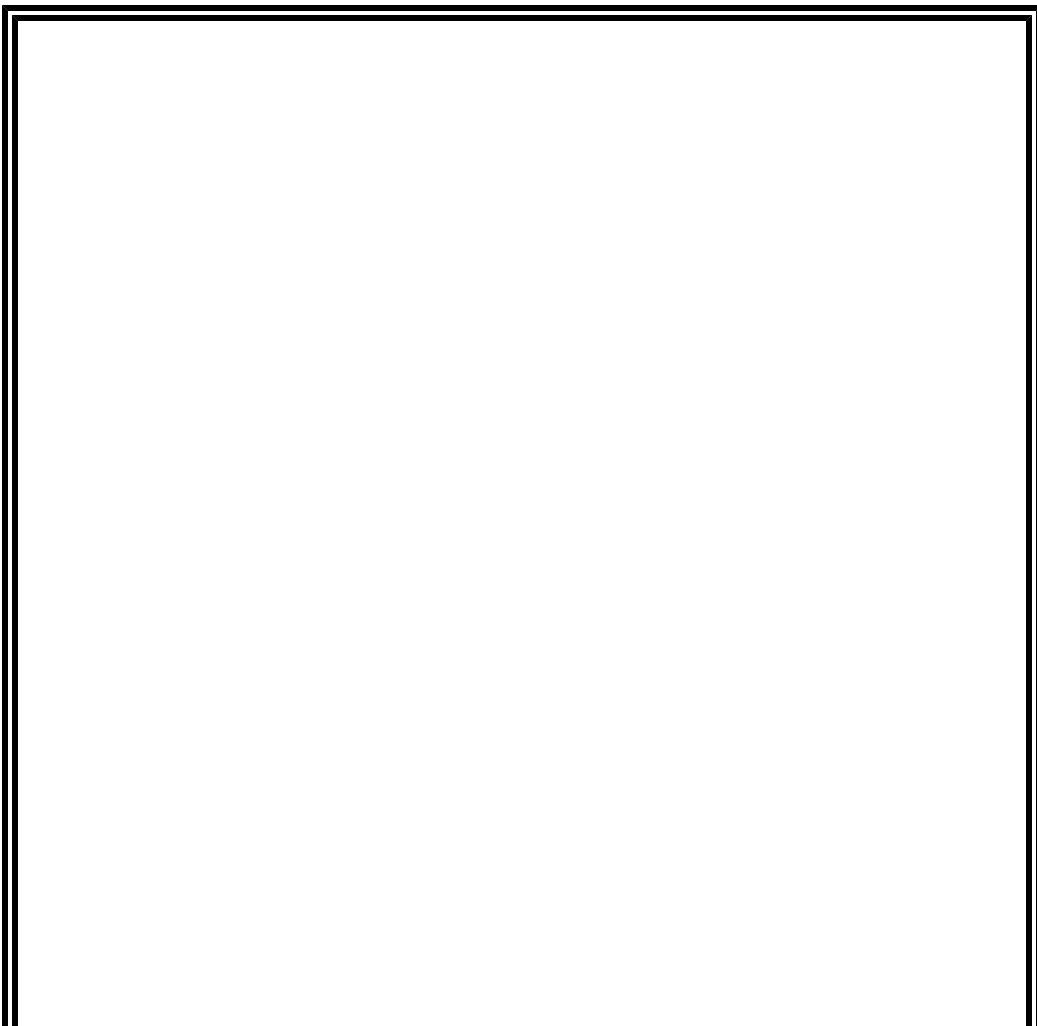


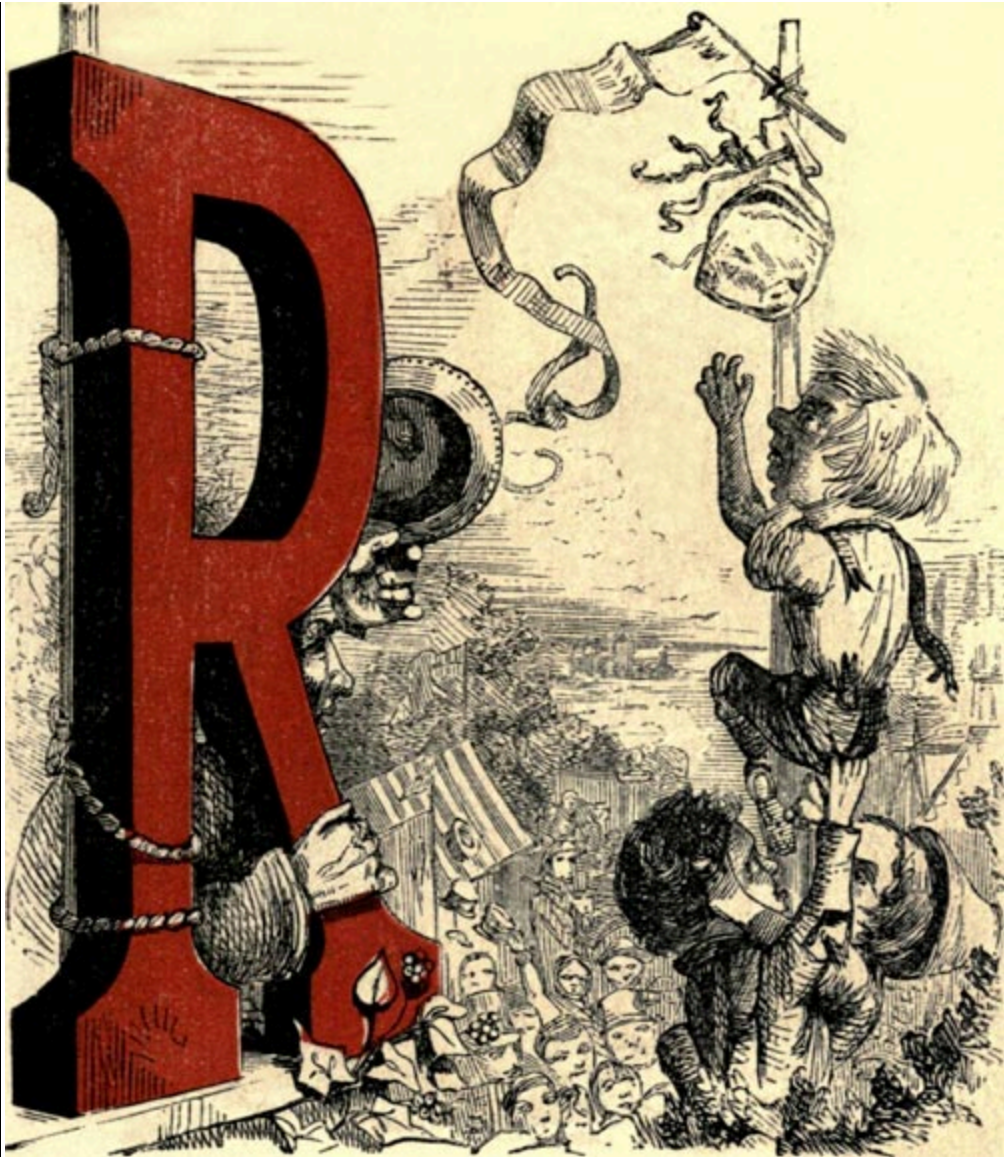
Qq.

QUANDARY,  
*A Doubt, a Difficulty.*

Dame Partlet's in difficulty  
And looks around with doubt:

Let's hope, as she some way got in,  
She may some way get out.



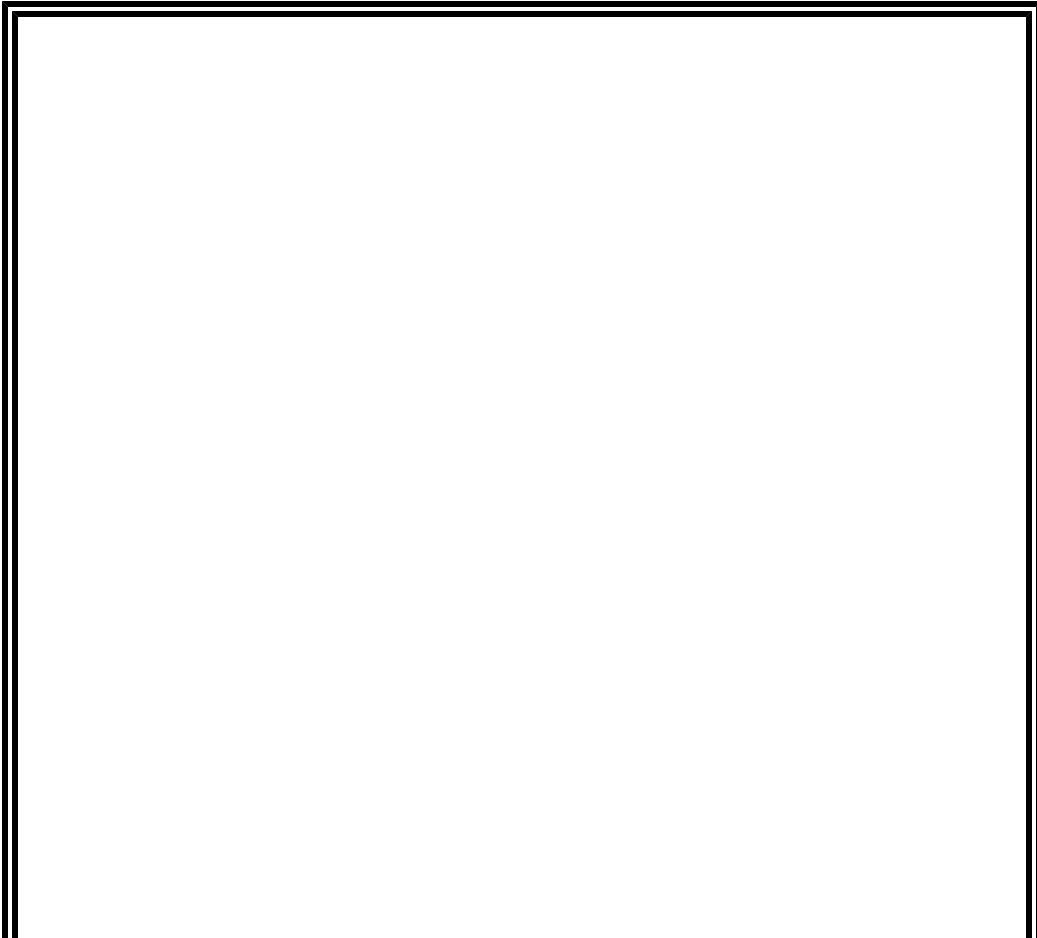


Rr.

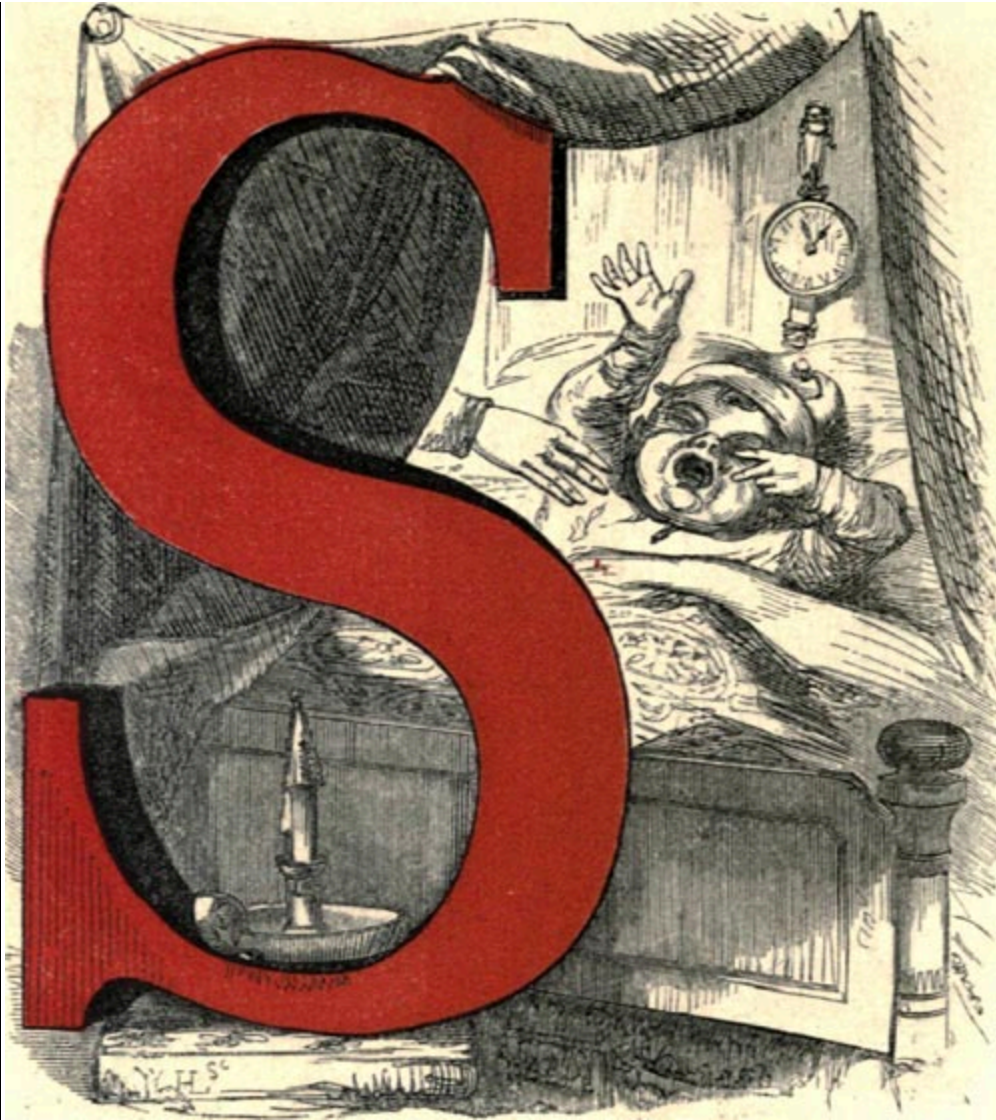
RIVALRY,  
*Competition, Emulation.*

In every competition prize

This should be kept in view—  
Whoever wins should be the one  
Who does deserve it, too.





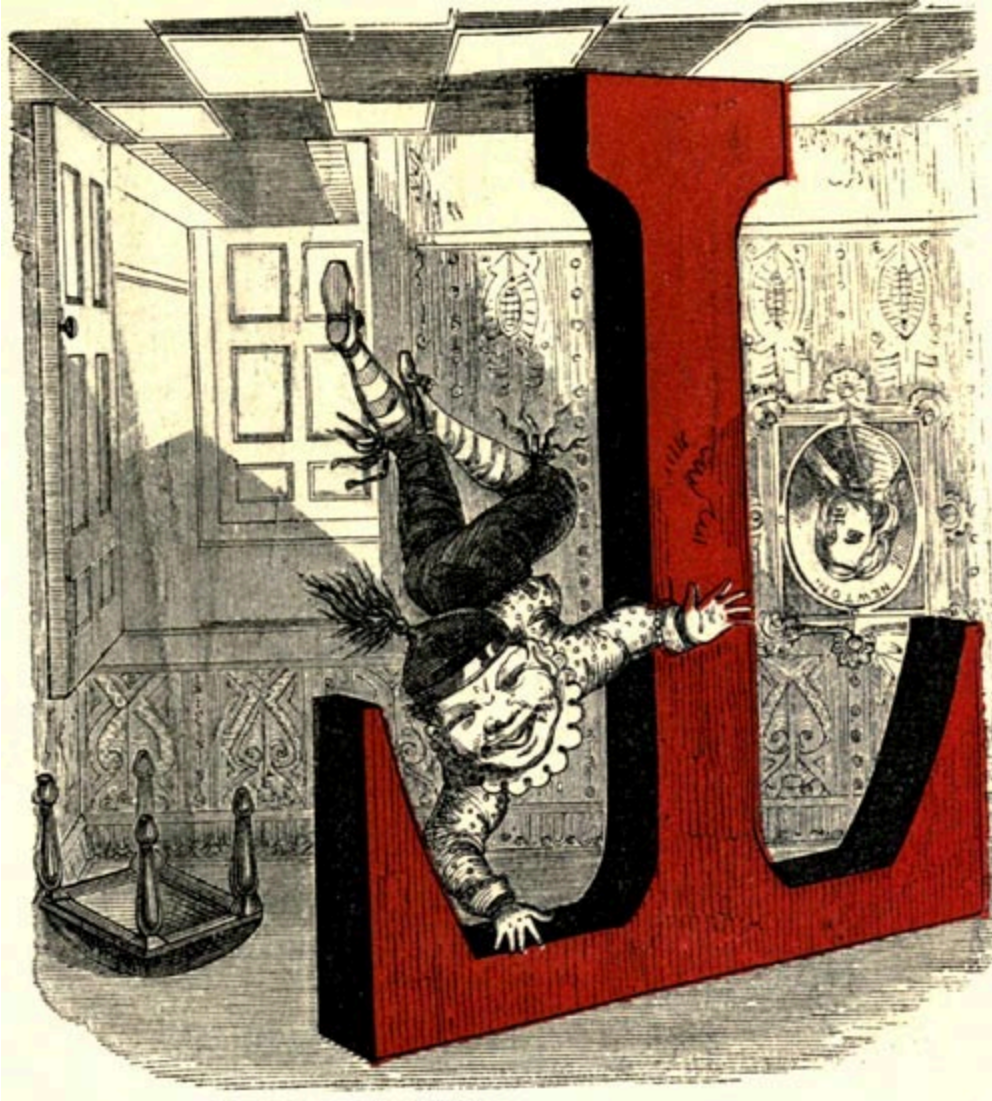


Ss.

SLUGGARD,  
*An Inactive, Lazy Fellow.*

To lie so many hours in bed  
You surely must be ill—

And need some physic, Master Ned,  
As birch, or draught, or pill!

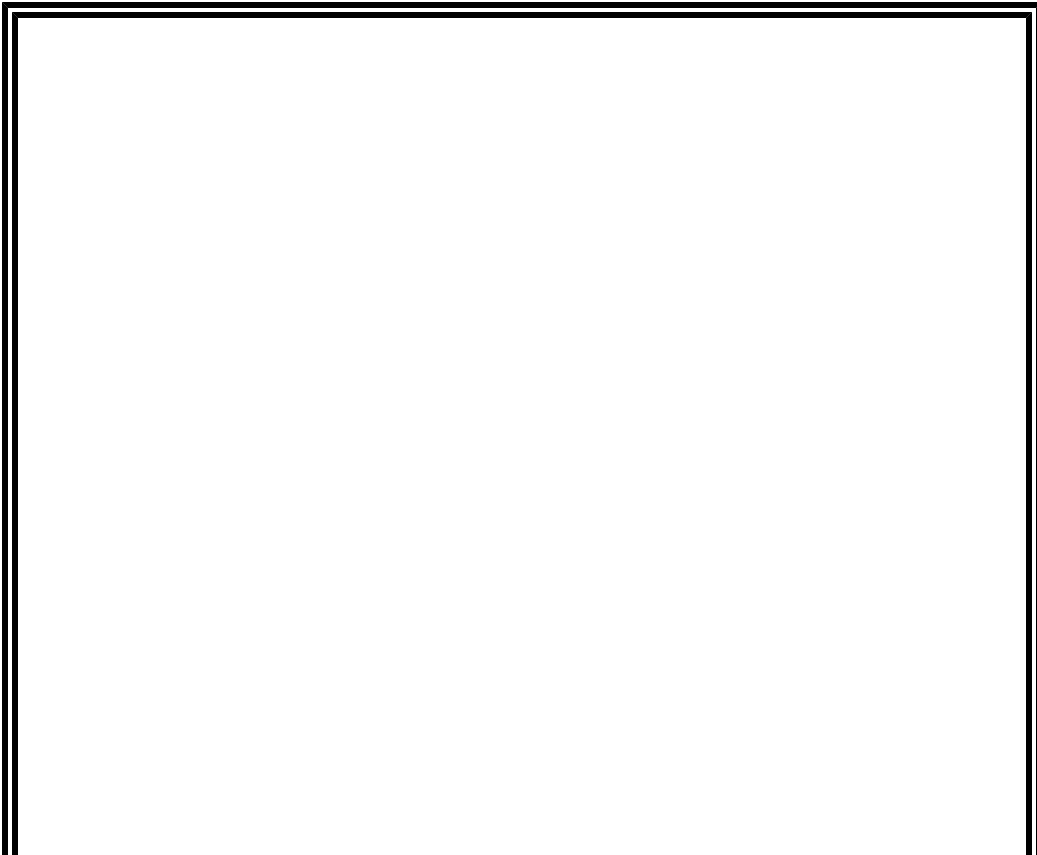


Tt.

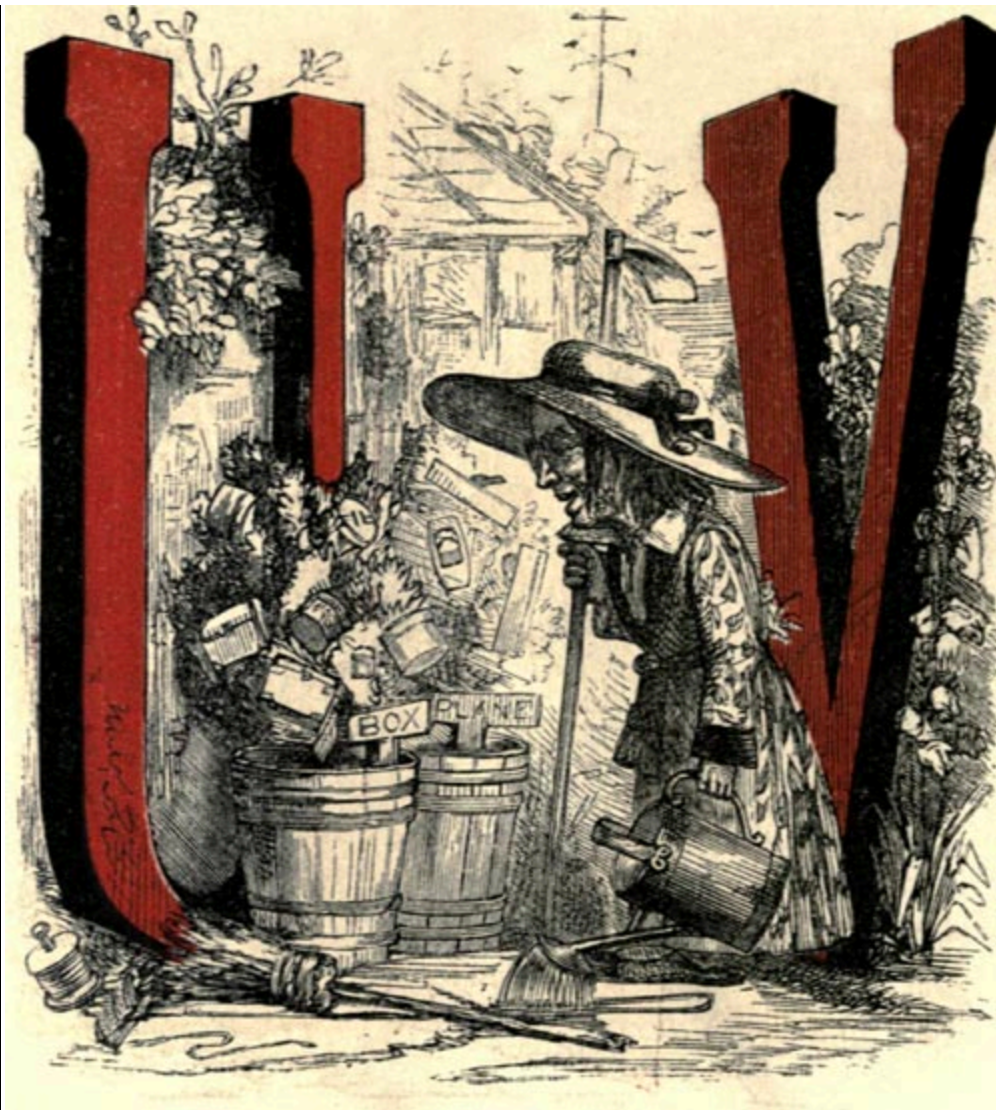
TOPSY-TURVY,  
*Upside Down, Bottom  
Top.*

Here's Topsy-Turvy, upside down,

The ceiling seems the base:  
Reverse the ground and 'twill be  
found  
The things are out of place.







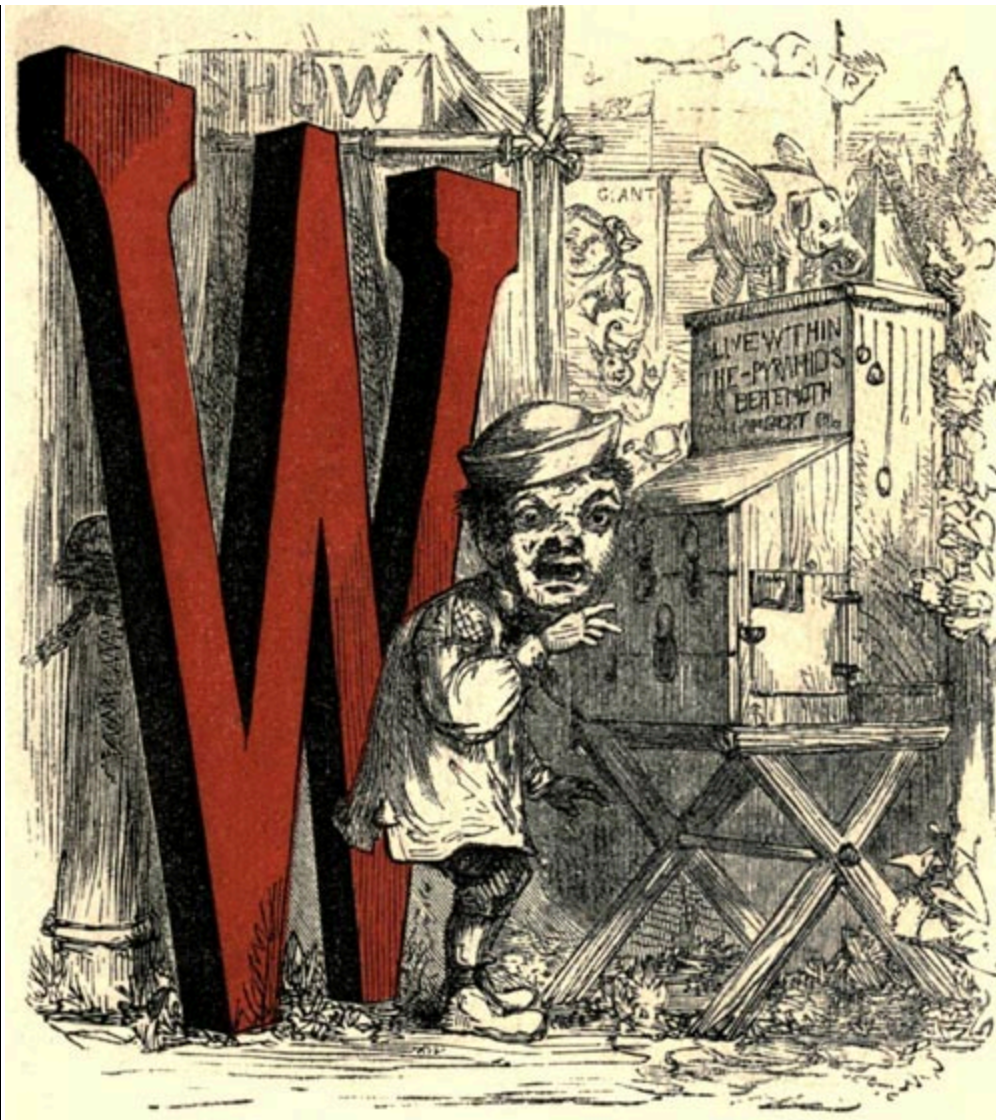
Uu.Vv.

UNCOMMON  
VEGETATION.

UNCOMMON, *Rare, not  
Frequent.*

VEGETATION, *the Power of  
Growth.*

Th' uncommon vegetation, here,  
With art has much to do:  
The trees are nature, but the fruit  
Uncommon and untrue.

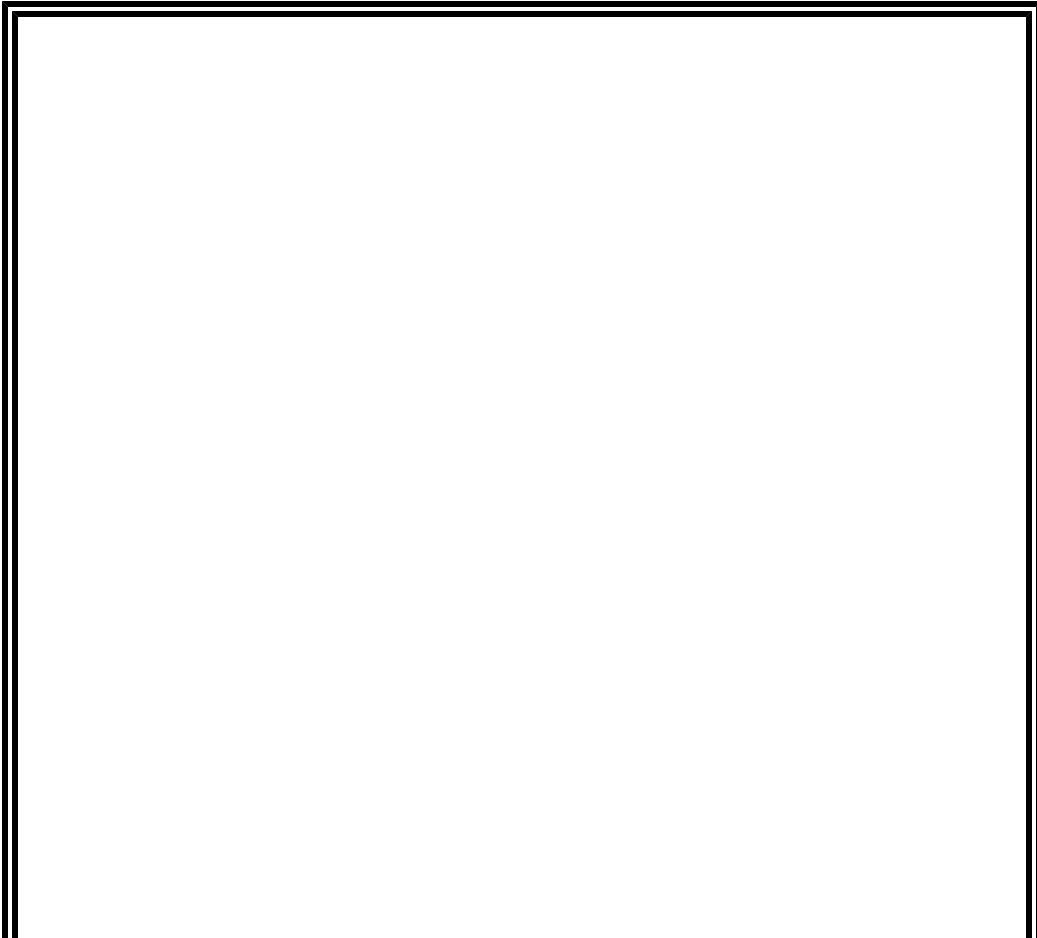


Ww.

WONDER,  
*Admiration,*  
*Astonishment.*

The wise may live and wonder still,

However much they know,  
But simple Giles has wonder found  
Within the penny show.





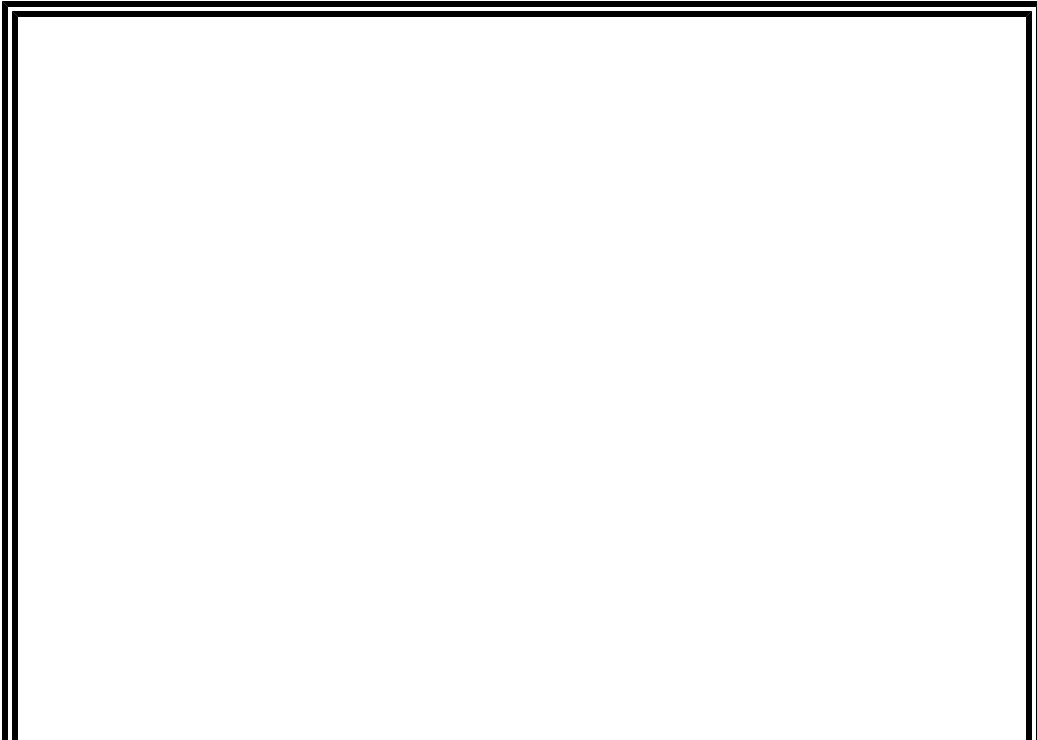


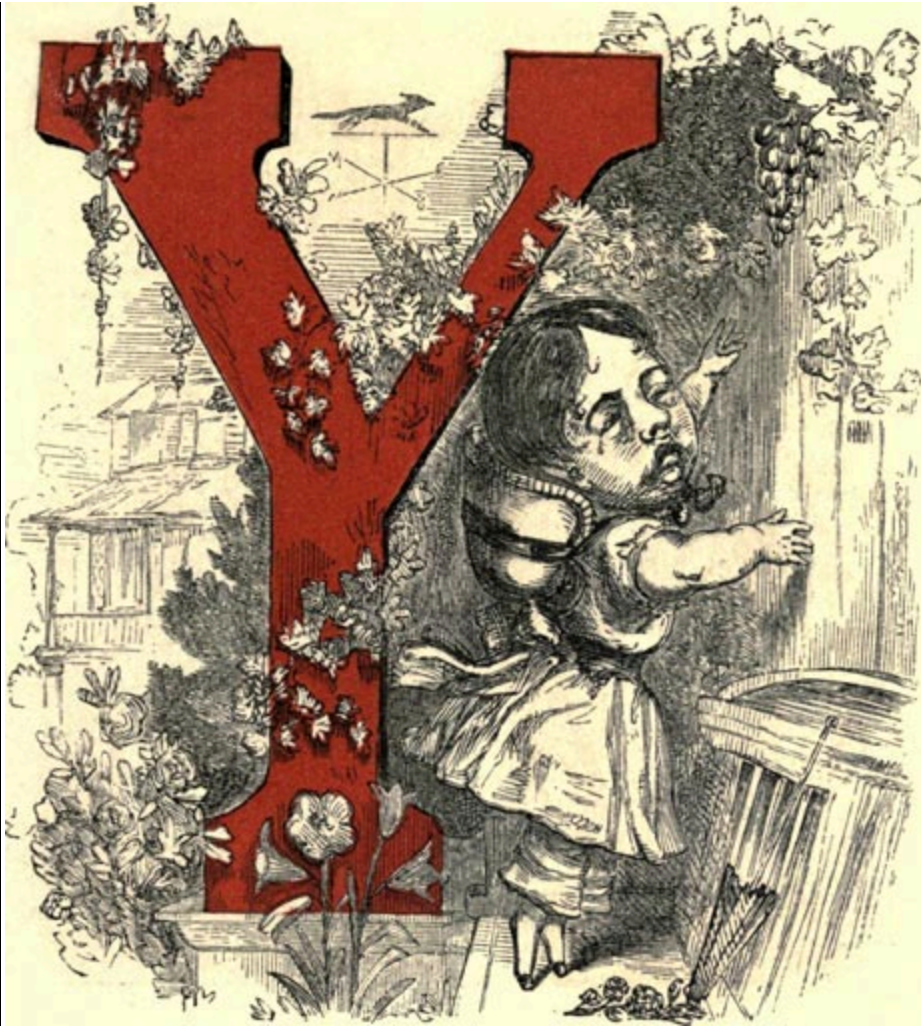
NO ENGLISH WORD BEGINS WITH THIS LETTER.

**Xx.**

XANTIPPE,  
*A Greek Matron, Wife of  
Socrates.*

Here's Socrates and Xantippe—  
Philosopher and wife—  
For gentleness renowned was he;  
She, better known for strife.



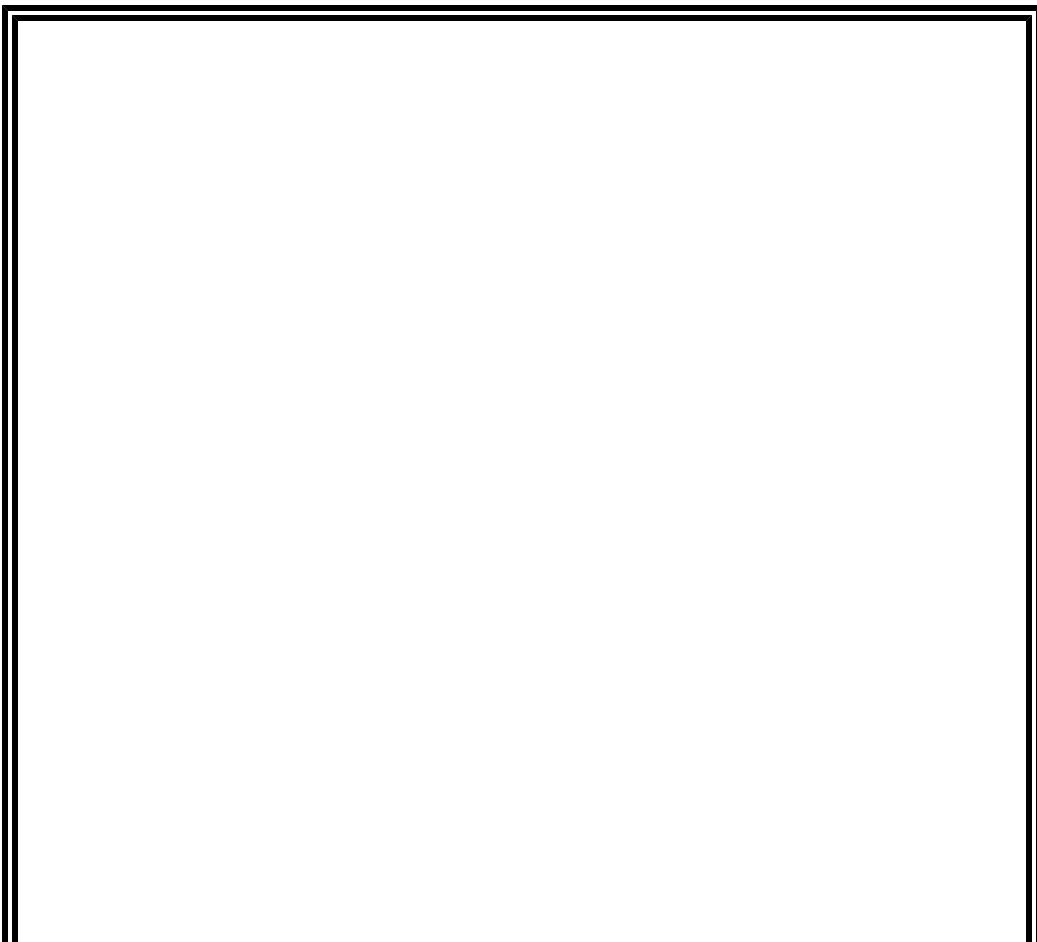


Yy.

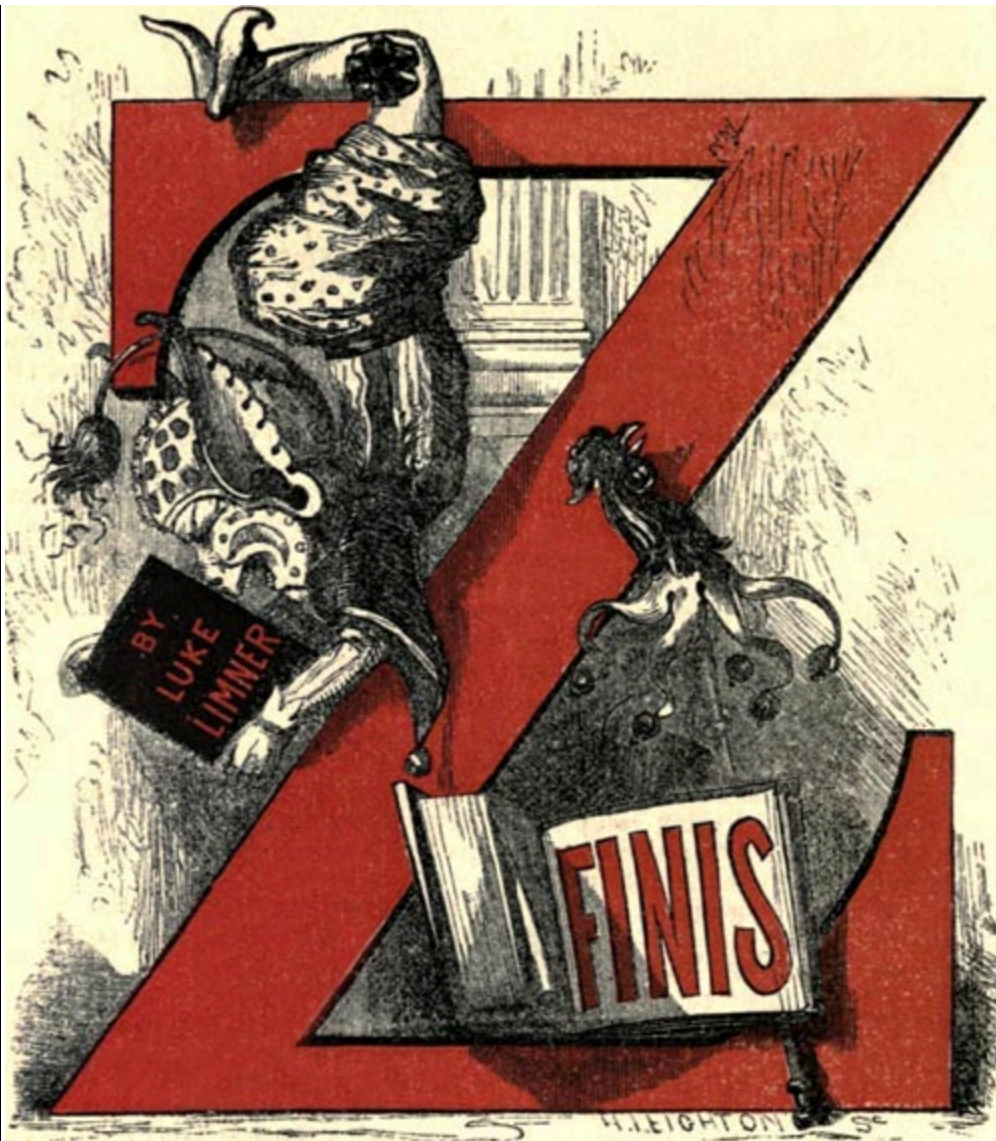
YEARN,  
*To Grieve, to Vex.*

Miss Cross has tried to reach the  
grapes,  
She's tried and tried again—

And now she's vexed to think that  
all  
Her efforts are in vain.







**Zz.**

ZANY,  
*A Buffoon, a Merry  
Andrew.*

Here's Zany reading in a book—  
With heels above his head—  
And, judging by his laughing look,  
Finds fun in what he's read.

---

## MORAL TALES.

---

ABLUTION.—Poor little fellow, you are certainly making comical faces: I fear the soap has got into your eyes, and that you will make that towel very black indeed. All boys, when they wash themselves, should take care to rinse off the soap and dirt before using the towel. To make the poor little sweep quite clean would take much washing. I should like to see the soap and water a little cleaner. Many of us have nice wash-stands and baths of marble, but this poor little fellow must make the best of what he can get. See how cleverly he has put a brick under the broken leg of the stool to prop it. I like to see boys clever and ingenious.

BARTER.—Miss Lucy Hart was a nice girl, but rather thoughtless, little regarding any time but the present—new things in her eyes being the prettiest and the best;—thus, she would cast away old toys for new ones, as if she were not likely to want them again. See, Master George Mc Gregor is bartering for her skipping-rope; offering some fruit in exchange for it. The fruit he has picked off the tree without permission. I know Lucy's mamma will be vexed; for not only will the fruit soon be gone, and the skip-rope wanted again, but it was a present from Papa. The plaything cost far more than a little fruit, which will be quickly eaten, and possibly make Lucy unwell after so much as she has had to-day.

CATASTROPHE.—Poor dear lady! has the cat tried to help himself to a gold fish, and overturned the handsome glass vase? Naughty Tom! greedy puss! I am sure kind Mrs. Blossom always feeds you well; and I think you know that

you have done wrong, or you would not run so fast over the rails into Admiral Seaworth's garden, where he keeps his large dog Neptune, who may bark and send you back in a fright.

Poor fish, see how they gasp!—run and fetch some water, or they will die. Men drown in water, but fish cannot live out of it. It is the nature of cats to catch mice and birds—so that we should keep our little favourites out of their reach.

DELIGHTFUL.—These boys, I fear, are bathing without their parents' consent, which is very wrong, indeed. It is very pleasant in the water on a fine day; but little boys should not go there, as it might be deep, and they might become cramped in their limbs, and be drowned when no one was near, as many naughty boys have been before now.

It is proper that boys should learn to swim, when with Papa or some kind friend, but not as these boys have. I feel just sure they have played the truant—as I see the village school-master, with his little dog, coming over the rustic bridge to catch them.

I think that the letter D might, in this case, stand for Disobedient as well as Delightful.

ECCENTRICITY.—What have we here?—a very odd, comical picture, indeed! What a strange fellow, to put his hat upon the fire, and a saucepan on his head. I do declare he has his trowsers and waistcoat on wrong side before. See, he has taken the poker for a walking-stick, put a greasy candle in the book, and the eggs upon the floor. Why a small baby-boy would not do this: the poor fellow must be out of his right mind. You may laugh at this odd picture for it is very ridiculous, and will hurt no one; but good children should never make sport of those who are deformed in mind or body, for it is not a fault but a misfortune to be so.



FRAUD.—Patrick Murphy—commonly called, for shortness, Pat—was a very stupid little man; he reared pigs, and had he been sober, would have by this time saved a little property; but, no, Pat liked beer and strong drink: so that upon market-days he was far less sensible than his own jackass—which did know its way home—and for a long time took back foolish tipsy Pat safely; until one day, the roads being very bad, the cart came to a stop, and Neddy could pull no further. A rogue passing, seeing Pat asleep, unloosed the donkey from the cart, leaving Pat to awake, and much wonder what could have become of Neddy Bray, the donkey.

It was very wrong of the man to take Pat's donkey, although Pat was a drunken fellow.

GENIUS.—Bravo! my little Artist. I dare say if you try again you will improve upon your first attempt. All people should learn to draw, that they may be able to describe a form in a very few lines, making things intelligible at sight which could not be described in any other way. A little knowledge of drawing will lead to a love of pictures and delight in the beautiful works of nature. Giotto, a great painter, who lived many hundred years ago, was but a poor shepherd-boy, who amused himself by drawing portraits of his sheep as he tended them on the hills; from rude attempts he rose to be a great artist, whose works are treasured by kings and princes. I dare say you may some day see some of the works of Giotto, the great Italian painter.

HORROR.—This drawing represents little Lady Selina Jemima Townsend as she appeared when afraid. Afraid—of what? Why, a poor tiny reptile, a harmless frog, that had jumped into her hat full of daisies, with a croak, as much as to say—“How do you do? Good morning, Lady Townsend; I am glad to see you down in the country.” But what do you think she did? Why, the little lady scampered away as fast as she could to her governess, in whose dress she hid her face, crying,—saying she had seen “a nasty horrid thing.” For this

her governess reproved her, saying, "God created nothing in vain." Frogs are harmless and beautiful when in the water, through which they can swim and dive with wonderful ease.

ICHABOD AT THE JAM.—Ichabod is an odd name, but such is the name of the little boy in the picture. He was much pampered by his parents, and never knew when he had had enough. Ichabod would cry for things to eat, then cry again because he could eat no more, and after all cry, because eating made him feel sick and ill: but that was not all; Ichabod was, I am ashamed to say, a thief. He stole the jam when his mother thought he was asleep in bed. See, Betty the maid has heard a noise, and caught the rogue in the act. To-morrow and for many days Ichabod will be ill in bed, and have to take much nasty physic. I wish he had *mis*-taken the mustard for honey, and burnt his naughty, fibbing tongue.

KNOWING.—Ah! ah! Jemmy Small. I fear the steeds are too knowing for you to-day. They appear conscious: they would like the beans and corn you have in the sieve, but do not like the halter you are hiding behind your back. More than one has kicked up his heels, as much as to say—"Catch me if you can!" You seem to think, as you bite the straw in your mouth, that they may give you a pretty run. I know Bob, the pony, will not be soon caught.

Horses and other animals like play much better than work, but good boys and girls ought to love both, and not require sweetmeats to induce them to do their duty—for they have intellects of a high order, and may become clever men and women.

LUCKY.—Master Lovebook was indeed lucky in his escape from the Bull—and I will tell you how it happened: In going to school, this young gentleman had to go round by the wood and across the meadows, when one day he observed a savage bull making towards him; alarmed, he did not run crying anywhere, but considered one moment, and made back

the shortest way to the wood, with all speed for the posts, just as the savage animal was going to toss him high in the air.

Master Lovebook was unfortunate in meeting the bull, but fortunate in having the posts between him and the infuriated animal.

In danger, brave little boys never cry, but think what is the best to be done.

MIMIC.—To be vain of anything is not right, and to be proud of fine clothes very silly indeed. The young gentleman in the picture, I think, is vain. See, he is smoking a cigar, and if we may judge by the expression of his face, we may presume that he does not fully enjoy it. As he struts along the rude boys ridicule him. See the boy behind mimicking his airs and graces—using the handle of the door-key for an eye-glass. I fear that lad's mirth will soon be changed into sorrow—for the jug must be broken against the post, and the beer spilled—so that in turn he will be laughed at.

We cannot help smiling at the little coxcomb, although at the same time we pity him.

NEGLIGENCE.—Here is Tommy Slowboy, the lowest boy in the day-school, too idle to learn or even play. See how vacantly he stands gaping at the men clearing the snow from the house-tops, with his hand in his pocket because he has lost his glove, having placed the hot shoulder of mutton down in the cold snow. No wonder the first dog passing helps itself to the joint. Tom will not only be chid, but have to go without his dinner. Yet, what cares Tom for scolding or anything else, he who is so neglectful of duty?

Mind that you strive to learn early, that you may become wise and happy hereafter. Look at the picture of Tommy Slowboy, and avoid apathy and indolence.

OBSTINACY.—Obstinacy is a sad thing. See the naughty Pig in the picture, how he pulls in the opposite

direction. Master Pig will be obliged to go into the sty, and very likely get the whip for his pains; like a wayward child that gets chid for disobedience. I hope there are very few disobedient young ladies and gentlemen, like the perverse pig. The pig is a stupid animal: but I have heard of a learned pig that could tell his letters, pointing to them with his snout; but most swine are dirty in their ways, and not at all particular—little caring so long as they can eat, grunt, and sleep. The pig will often lie in the dirtiest corner of his house, and stand in its trough of food.

PETS.—Here is a portrait of Aunt Gray feeding her Pets, or rather stuffing the poor monkey. Some people say Miss Gray is kind to animals, but I do not think so, for she keeps her pets prisoners—feeding them too much, and all for her own pleasure, until they become like spoilt children, peevish, and always wanting sweet things. Kind children love animals, and delight to see them free. In the Zoological Gardens animals are not pets; they have there plenty of room, and are nicely kept for our instruction. See, poor Jacko, the monkey, has grown too fat to leap, as in his native woods he used, from bough to bough. The poor gold fish have hardly room to turn in their glass prison: how they would enjoy a swim in the garden pond!

QUANDARY.—Poor Dame Partlet having got into the back yard cannot get out again. She is in a Quandary, for she fears the dogs will bite her—though their chains are not long enough. Keeper, the mastiff, is a noble fellow, and would not hurt women or children; neither would Nero, the bull-dog; he would rather face a lion or a wild ox: whilst Snap, the terrier, barks and snarls in the company of his brave companions.

Little boys and girls should not touch strange dogs, for they sometimes snap at those who are not familiar to them. To take food from dogs is not prudent, for they growl, bite, and are ill-tempered, like a little fellow would be if deprived of his dinner, after he had tasted the first morsel.



RIVALRY.—To compete for good is famous—such as little boys rivalling one another in a race up the Ladder of Learning—that is exercise of the mind. Here we have a picture of country boys exercising their strength—climbing up a pole covered with grease, for a prize of food for the body. The boy that wins the leg of mutton will be the hero of the fair, and be carried round the place on the shoulders of the men. See how they strive and tear to win the prize. I should not wonder if they all slipped down together, notwithstanding the encouraging cheers of the crowd. See how the man on the housetop swings his hat in the air, and the people applaud. A few inches higher, and the prize is won.

SLUGGARD.—Heavy-headed, sleepy Ned, awake, arise! You lazy fellow! Look at the clock! Eight hours' rest is enough for any little boy—and here you have taken nearly fourteen. All Sluggards should get their slates, and calculate how much time they waste every year—weeks that can never be regained. If you only lie in bed two hours later than you should every day, you lose more than one day in a week, or sixty-four days in the course of the year: which, at the end of seventy years, would be awful indeed! Twelve whole years lost! Lazy, idle people, never seem to have time for anything: industrious ones, time for anything and everything. I hope when little Ned sees his portrait he will be shocked with his appearance, and reform his ways.

TOPSY-TURVY.—Well, of all the funny pictures in this droll book I think this the drollest—a big letter T resting on its top on the ceiling, like in an overturned doll's house, or a view taken by an artist standing upon his head. Turn it over, and see how comical it looks—everything appears to have lost its gravity.

*Gravity* means the power that holds us to the earth (as Papa's loadstone attracts the needle): if it were not for gravity, we could not move about. Some day you shall read in that nice book called the "Evenings at Home," about gravity, and

why an apple falls to the ground. A great philosopher, Sir Isaac Newton, discovered why, as he lay under a tree. At a future time you will learn about gravity and many other things.

UNCOMMON VEGETATION.—Uncle Periwinkle was very kind; he loved nature and his nephews dearly. He wore green spectacles, a dressing-gown all covered with leaves, and a large straw hat; in fact he was very fond of gardening, and reared all kinds of odd plants—this his nephews knew, and determined to play a joke upon him—not a cruel, heartless joke, that would hurt or destroy anything: no! they were too kind for that. They only carefully tied the carpenter's planes upon the plane-tree, as if it were fruit—and some little boxes of all colours upon the box-tree, like blossom; so that when the old gentleman beheld it, he exclaimed—"Uncommon Vegetation!" upon which John and Walter came laughing out of the greenhouse to receive a bunch of fine grapes for their pleasant joke.

WONDER.—So, Master Ploughboy Giles, you are spending your penny and your holiday at the fair. You seem not a little astonished at what you have seen in that peep-show. Surely you cannot imagine that they are real; it is the magnifying power of the glasses that makes the pictures appear so large. The pyramids of Egypt are the largest stone buildings in the world, and the oldest; the Behemoth, a huge animal that existed thousands of years ago (but I do not think it had wings like a butterfly, as in the showman's picture); Daniel Lambert was an enormously fat man, who died a long time back. All these things must be in miniature if they are to be seen in that small box, very little larger than a dog's house.

XANTIPPE.—The comical event pictured here occurred more than two thousand years ago: Xantippe, the wife of the great and good philosopher Socrates, continually tormented him with her ill-humour—using him very cruelly—one day emptying a vessel of dirty water over her celebrated husband,

whom she ought to have loved: he only remarked, that “after thunder there generally falls rain.” Socrates lived in the refined city of Athens; he was one of the most eminent philosophers of Greece; he was very plain in person, as you perceive by the picture: but a man may be great and good, yet ugly, as Socrates was. The philosopher had enemies who sought his destruction; he was killed with poison. After his death his accusers were despised, as you will read in ancient history some day.

YEARN.—What have we here? Little Miss Cross vexed, just because she cannot get at the grapes. I am sure I should not like to have my portrait drawn with such a sullen face. She has been trying to take fruit without her aunt’s permission, that very likely is unripe and improper for her. The walk in a delightful garden ought not to make her long to eat all the fruit she sets eyes upon, or wish to pick the sweet flowers, that last much longer upon the plants than when plucked. I perceive that the peevish young lady in the picture has been picking the flowers. See, they are strewn upon the seat beside her, under those dirty feet that have trodden down the beds of mould. I am afraid Miss Cross cannot be a joyous, happy child, because disobedient.

ZANY.—Finis is the Latin word for finish, and here it is the last droll picture—a Zany laughing at his portrait in this comical book, which he seems vastly to enjoy. What a droll fellow, to read with his head where his heels should be, like the clown in the pantomime. Look at his staff, the cock and bells, with which he dances, making a jingling noise. A Zany is not an idiot, but often a funny clever fellow, paid to make people laugh. We all like a good laugh sometimes. Many years ago kings used to keep jesters to amuse the company; King Henry the Eighth had a clever jester, called Will Somers, whose portrait was painted by a great artist named Holbein, which is now in the palace at Hampton Court, and may be seen by those who love pictures.

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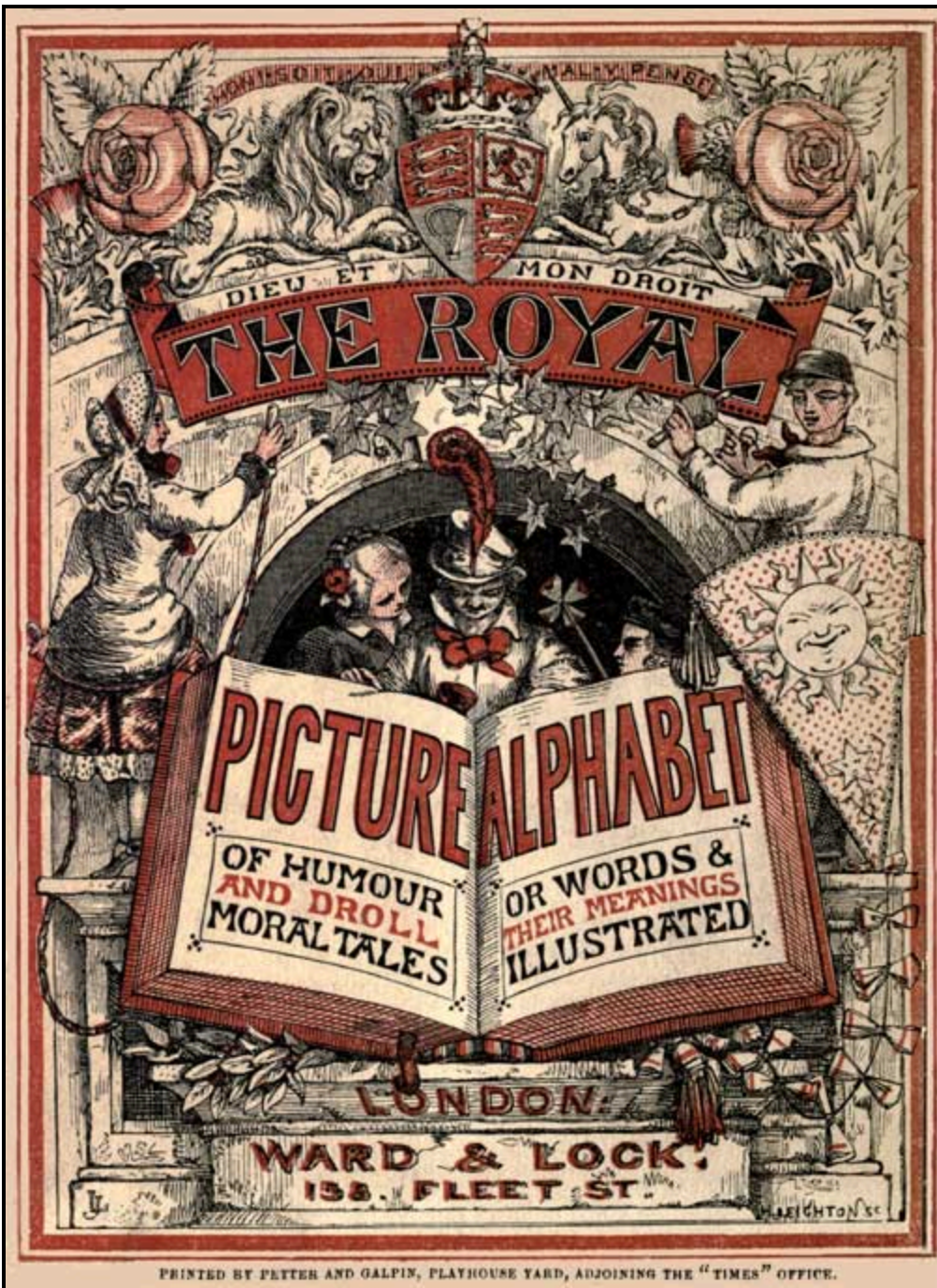
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